Blade in the Crowd

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/53227609.

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Mature

Archive Warning:
Graphic Depictions Of Violence

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F/F

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018), Assassin's Creed - All Media Types

Relationships:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Minor or Background Relationship(s)

Characters:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra), Glimmer (She-Ra), Bow (She-Ra), Hordak (She-Ra), Angella (She-Ra), Spinnerella (She-Ra), Netossa (She-Ra), Juno (Assassin's Creed)

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by Ogjnogth

Summary

Orphans taken in by Madame Weaver, Adora and Catra are thrust into an ages old war between two secret societies for the fate of humanity, while also learning of their own true nature.

—

Catradora in your average Assassins Creed plot

—

Note- This fic is AC newbie friendly. There are dream sequences which may be confusing, but prior knowledge is not required to enjoy the story. (Hopefully)

Notes

Assassin's Creed really is one of those series that you go into thinking it'll be normal and then it hits you with "LBJ was a deep-cover agent for the Knights Templar and JFK was killed because there was ancient aliens tech on the moon and the Templars wanted to keep it away from the Soviets so they used Lee Harvey Oswald as a sleeper agent to kill him while having the leader of the Assassin-turned-Templar leader of the CIA trick the assassins into thinking JFK needed to die."

This isn't particularly relevant in any way, I just think it's amusing.

Chapter 1

"She still won't listen! 'Mother of Wisdom', my ass!"

Aurora turned around from her work on Consus's project to see her lover. Astra clearly was enraged at Juno's belligerence— She and the rest of the Capitoline Triumvirate were hell bent on fighting this war with their slaves, even as the threat of Coronal Mass Ejection became more and more real. Add on top of that Aita's self-sacrifice to the mind transfer so that the Isu may yet survive, and that even Jupiter and Minerva were beginning to grow tired of her power hunger, she supposed her drive for survival had gone into overdrive. Too bad really- as Consus had shown, even depriving the apes of the ability to Know and creating technology to control them, they were still, on some level, Isu. Lesser than them, obviously, but Yaldabaoth's narcissistic decision to make their beasts of burden be designed in their likeness and image had caused some truly interesting consequences. All it took was a few instances in interbreeding to create an uprising— truly the Isu spirit was alive and well.

Aurora pulled the shorter girl into her arms, rested her forehead in her hair. "It doesn't matter what Juno thinks. Consus's work still will go on as intended. Even her meddling with the machines will not prevent humanity from going on."

Astra mumbled something, but Aurora failed to hear it, as shouting came from somewhere else.

"Adora!"

—

"Hey! Adora!"

Adora bolted upright in her bed, her best friend Catra laying on top of her, heterochromatic eyes staring into her soul.

“Wake up. Cobalt’s gonna show us around the factory overseer job. Weaver’ll kill me if we come too late, and I wanna get some decent time to eat.”

The blonde shook off her sleep and began to get dressed into her finery. She and Catra had not even ten years ago been street urchins struggling to survive, her parents having died in a carriage accident and Catra having never known hers. They had met on the streets, begging and stealing to feed themselves, and were instantly drawn to one another.

Just seven short years ago, they had been taken off the streets and raised by Madame Weaver, the kindly wife of a wealthy industrialist who had seen their plight and taken them in. Their story of rags to riches still astonished her— she had went from almost illiterate to well-read within years. Wearing the same filthy clothes ever day to having a wardrobe of beautifully crafted dresses. Badly malnourished to a woman of great health.

Having pulled on her crimson dress, she turned to see Catra dressed far more casually and in an attire far more suited for a working class man, apparently uninterested in making a good impression

“Catra, you wonder why Weaver doesn’t like you as much as me and yet you dress like that!”

Catra rolled her eyes at Adora’s admonishment. “I am not and will never be a lady.” She turned towards the door to their room. “C’mon. Let’s get this over with.”

Walking out from the bedroom to the Weaver Estate’s dining room, she saw the Madame sitting at the head of the table, dressed in a luxurious crimson gown. Sat next to Weaver was a tall, burly man, speaking quietly with the woman, upon noticing the young girls entering the room, Weaver spoke out to them.

“Adora, Good Morning. And you too, Catra. I see you are truly making the best of my gifts.”

Ignoring her best friend's scoff, the blonde took a seat at her normal spot beside Weaver, Catra next to her. She then began to eat her breakfast that had been prepared, taking care to use the proper table manners Weaver had taught them, which she could already guess. Catra would disregard.

As they ate, Weaver introduced them to the overseer. "Cobalt, these are the girls my husband and I rescued off the streets. Part of his idea of sharing the wealth. We took them in, had them educated, raised them to be proper ladies." She sneered towards Catra, "some took to it better than others."

Cobalt spoke up, gruff voice grunting, "I'm not sure why he thought the weaker sex would be capable of such work."

Weaver sweetly responded, "My dear Cobalt, factory work was designed for the least common denominator. Even a child can work a machine, and they do! To have a woman run a factory is simply the future— to streamline work so that the workforce can be doubled. And, as these girls are… largely educated, I see no reason why they could not function above the common rabble as an overseer to my husband's industry."

Cobalt grunted in acceptance, and then spoke to the girls. "The Kur Company helps to produce linen products. As an overseer my job is to make sure the workers do their job efficiently. Idle hands are the devil's playthings, after all."

—

After breakfast, the girls followed Cobalt to his carriage, where they sat in silence as it drove from the estate to the Kur Factory in the nearby city of Bright Moon.

Arriving, they got out and followed Cobalt into the factory. He showed them around the machines, explained how they worked, and the rate at which the workers should be moving. He then walked into his office to work on paperwork, ensuring the

employees were paid for their grueling labor, and leaving the girls to their own devices.

Rather quickly, Adora came to the conclusion that perhaps Catra wasn't far off in deciding to wear men's clothing— her dress was not exactly designed to be worn in such filthy, crowded conditions. Though that also alerted her attention— the vile conditions of the building. Grime lurked around every corner, workers were bathed in soot, and at least one person was seriously injured during their shift. Even worse was looking at the children- children she was supposed to be working to the bone. While she would not wish her earlier life on anyone, and the salary of a factory worker, meager as it was, undoubtedly was preferable to begging for spare change, she had to wonder exactly how much better it truly was.

Catra had slunk off a while ago, in Adora's mind probably by the edge of the building. She wandered off to see if she could find her friend and coax her into… something. The longer she stood in this building, the bleaker it appeared.

Eventually she did see Catra, smoking by the factory entrance, but also speaking to an Asian woman, clearly as overdressed as Adora herself was, in her ornate purple dress. She couldn't make out what they were saying, but from gestures she could infer she was being directed to Cobalt's office.

As the woman walked off, Adora slunk up next to her best friend, laying her head on Catra's shoulder. Catra turned to her, face clearly weighted with exhaustion. She offered the cigarette to the blonde

"Wanna smoke?"

Adora slapped her hand at the tobacco. "No. Where did you even get that?"

Catra shrugged, "Someone had a bunch. Thought they wouldn't miss one."

Adora looked admonishingly at the self-admitted thief. “Catra! You can’t just go around stealing people’s things!”

Catra chuckles to herself. “You can take the kid off the streets but you can’t take the streets out of the kid.” Stretching out with a yawn and then taking a puff of her cigarette, she snarked, “Life in a factory everything you dreamed?”

Adora sighed to herself. “I mean I didn’t expect some sort of luxurious place, but… there are kids there, as old as we were. And I know, they’re better here than on the streets but… the other guards… they had whips. Weaver’ll want us to whip them.”

Catra scoffed. “That’s capitalism for you. Work your ass off to enrich some asshole so they can pay you in your own shit.” Adora tried not to respond to Catra’s language— as coarse as the statement was, she couldn’t find it in her to disagree, really.

Eager to end this conversation, Adora veered towards the woman she saw talk to Catra. “Hey, who was that lady you spoke to? In the purple dress?”

Catra just shrugged. “Called herself Ms Moon. Said she had business with Cobalt. Probably some sort of dealings. Seemed like the sort with money.”

Adora just nodded along. Honestly, she didn’t care much. As much as her studies in history certainly would suggest that life today was better than in times past, she couldn’t help but feel almost disenchanted. Cobalt would absolutely come down to get them back to work, but as it stood, Adora just felt like dozing off with her best friend.

—

It was the late afternoon when the two of them were woken— not by a disgruntled factory owner but the shriek of a young woman, coming from inside the building.

Adora startled to alertness, initially assuming someone was injured by a machine. She shook Catra awake, and the two of them went inside to check the procedure for on site injuries with the owner. But as they walked in, she couldn't help noticing the flocking of the workers to Cobalt's office. Gently pushing her way up the stairs to his room, she saw what they were all gawking at.

Cobalt lay bleeding in his chair, his lean into the chair exposing his slit throat, blood seemingly wiped across the slash.

She ran over to check his body, see if there was any possibility of saving him— but in her rush, she was stopped dead in her tracks by something in his hand.

A scrap of ripped purple fabric.

Whoever killed him was wearing purple.

Ms. Moon.

Chapter 2

Chapter Notes

> The story is taking place in New England in the 1890s. Little bit after AC Syndicate, little before WWI. Probably not super important, but I do still want to stick to the classic AC pseudohistory and have it grounded-ish. So yeah. I did a lil research, there's some real life politics that will be referenced.

Aurora barely even knew what Juno was rambling on about at this point. At first, it was clear. The humans were nothing more than oxen, yet Isu bastard children had created a revolution. Coronal mass ejection this, Project Anthropos that. She pitied the Mother, of course— Aita had sacrificed himself to Consus' work and was now in a coma, so she had quested to get the serum necessary for her husband's resurrection. If Aurora had been in her shoes, and Astra in Aita's, she would have done the same. But still…

"Maybe we should have allowed the humans to be free." Aurora suggested. "They are made in our likeness and image, after all. Why treat them as nothing more than slaves?"

Juno glared at Aurora. "Consus thought the same thing. Humans are fascinating. An inferior race to our own who emulate us. But that's not why they exist. Animals evolve, like us. They are drones, nothing more."

Aurora sighed. The Mother clearly wasn't budging on the topic.

Suddenly she heard a knock from the walls.

"Adora!"

—

Adora jolted upright in her bed, trying to shake off the dream.

These dreams had existed since she was little— as long as she had known Catra, really. Not that she had told anyone. The mere fact that she had been dreaming about Roman gods as an illiterate child on the streets with zero knowledge of mythology was weird enough when she ignored the fact that it had become its own story in her head. She'd heard that dreams had meaning, but these didn't feel like some sort of metaphor— they felt like memories.

Adora looked down at Catra, curled up on the blonde's bed despite having her own— the two were inseparable on the streets, and even seven years of luxury hadn't stopped it. She wished she could talk to Catra about her dreams, but then she'd have to acknowledge Astra— the goddess married to her own. Aurora's lover. The goddess who was very clearly Catra.

Every detail, her mismatched eyes, unruly hair, tan skin, snarky wit, everything convinced her that Astra and Catra were one and the same.

Adora would be lying if she said Aurora's love for Astra hadn't bled into her over time. Even if she knew that it wasn't right for one girl to love another like that, she did.

Softly shifting, she moved out of her bed, trying not to wake her best friend. Friend. That's what she was, her best friend, family really. And one of the mansion's servants had come knocking, so she should stop brooding and go to breakfast— Catra would catch up later. She overslept all the time.

Walking through the halls towards the dining room, she took in the opulence of the Weaver estate— it felt less like a house that belonged in New England and more a country home for a European royal, brought across the Atlantic by a rich businessman. It was nearly a decade ago when she first saw these walls, in awe at the luxury she had been brought into. After yesterday, it felt different. Seeing the putrid conditions of Cobalt's factory made it feel almost sickening. She had thought that the

squalor of her and Catra's life before was just their misfortune, but seeing the life of those people supposedly better off…

Entering the dining room, she spotted Madame Weaver speaking to a group of police officers. Probably about Cobalt.

Adora shuddered. First day seeing the working world, and the factory owner is killed, by a woman who just walked in the front door, on her and Catra's watch.

Upon noticing her entrance, Weaver dismissed the officers and waved Adora over. "Adora, come, sit down."

Adora slid silently into her chair, slowly picking at her food with her fork, baking under the heat of the lady of the house's gaze.

"A violet dress was found outside the window of Cobalt's office. Stripped off, thrown into the street. 'Ms Moon' appears to have been a pseudonym— the name does not connect to anyone."

Adora continued staring a hole in her omelette. She should have done something. She should have followed Ms Moon, not just brooded with Catra, she should have-

"I apologize for yesterday, Adora," Weaver clearly stated, startling the blonde out of her spiraling. "I knew that you would learn about this sooner or later, but I had hoped it would be on my terms."

Noticing Adora's confused glance, she continued. "Do you know why I wanted you to see that place?"

Adora scrunched her brows. "So that I would have a better grasp of the way business worked?" That was what Weaver told her, after all.

For her part, Weaver just chuckled to herself. "I suppose I should be glad you trust me so easily. But it is more complicated."

Weaver stood from her chair, moving towards the door to her husband's study. She gestured towards Adora, "Come, walk with me."

Abandoning her eggs, Adora joined the tall woman. "If it wasn't that, why did you send us there?"

"So you could see how the world works." Stepping into the study, Weaver called attention to the maid dusting the room and, with a flick of her wrist, dismissed her.

Door to the study now closed behind the servant, Weaver stalked over to a fancy globe sitting on the desk of her husband, slowly spinning it. "I trust that you understand the improvement of society in the past centuries?"

Adora pursed her lips in thought. "Yes. The change from feudal to industrial, monarchic to liberal, autocratic to democratic, theocratic to scientific…"

"What if I were to tell you that these societal improvements were not achieved by simple human achievement, but instead that the world was intentionally led through these changes?"

Adora stared at Weaver in confusion. "You mean by God?"

Weaver simply laughed. "No. I mean by individuals with wisdom beyond that of ordinary men. By men with the power and intent to protect humanity, guide it towards peace and civilization, away from chaos and barbarism."

Adora squinted at Weaver. "I'm not sure I understand."

Weaver moved towards the study's bookshelves, "I trust you have heard of the Holy Order of the Knights Templar?"

"The Catholic military order from the Crusades?" The longer this conversation went on, the more confused by Weaver's words Adora became.

"Indeed. Though its care for Catholic dogma certainly waned over time… and by no means did they disappear after the Church's disbandment."

"And what does this have to do with a factory?"

Weaver merely chuckled to herself, "Humans are… fickle. We claim to want freedom, but do not know what that freedom means. We support progress, but burn heretics at the stake. If left to its own devices, human progress would inevitably stagnate, and return to the dark ages."

Turning to Adora, Weaver stood straight. "That is why our job as Templars is so important. The protection of progress and civilization, and guidance of humankind to the future it did not know it wanted."

Adora's head was spinning. "But the Templars were disbanded in 1312 after-"

Weaver cut her off, "After Grandmaster Jacques de Molay was burnt at the stake, yes, but not before the order went underground. Not even two centuries later one of our own had become head of the Catholic church, Pope Alexander VI."

Adora thoroughly stunned, Weaver continued. "Our purpose in sending the two of you to Cobalt's factory was to help you to understand the world our order has carefully crafted. As much as humanity clamors for liberty, it craves order. Stability. And so, we provide jobs for men, women, children, which can be done by any. They manufacture the linen which is used to make the clothing others buy, and they are given money for bread and meat. A simple arrangement, but one that works. One that provides a simple, understandable hierarchy that one can grasp at a glance."

Weaver turned to Adora. "Unfortunately, not everyone agrees with our actions, as you have seen with Cobalt's death. I wished to have been able to present our ideas to you in a better time, but unfortunately the Order's enemies have forced our hand."

The tall lady handed a paper scrawled with writing to Adora. “As you may know, Governor Russel is running for president. One of the Order’s agents functions as an advisor to his political life. We have reason to believe that this agent is under threat by our enemies. With any luck, your preventing this attack will be a great boon in discovering Cobalt’s murderer, and will convince Grandmaster Prime to accept you as a full member.”

Adora took a seat, reading the paper for any information on “D T Winchester”, the governor’s campaign manager.

“Oh, and Adora?” The blonde looked up at her name being said, “Tell none of this to Catra.”

Chapter 3

Chapter Notes

> TW: DT is referred to as a man. It's the 1890s so maybe that's more okay, but thought I'd give a heads up. Either way, there is still very clearly Gender (tm) amok

See the end of the chapter for more notes

"I still don't understand why you refuse to wear the clothes Madame Weaver gave us."

The girls were at a gala for Governor Russel's presidential campaign, dressed in their finest clothes. Or at least Adora was. Catra had begrudgingly accepted that fancy clothing would be good for such an event… and then proceeded to steal a slightly-too-big tuxedo from Weaver's husband's wardrobe. As much as she claimed otherwise, Adora couldn't really blame her— Catra really wouldn't be herself if she didn't constantly fly in the face of custom. That and the gown that the blonde was wearing was a massive burden, and would be no help towards her second goal.

Weaver had sent the two girls to the governor's gala allegedly as attempting to make connections and ease into the governmental life. But Adora was well aware of her true purpose. Whoever had killed Cobalt, had their sights on the governor's campaign manager, D T Winchester, a fellow member of the Templar Order. Winchester was responsible for making sure the ordinarily pro-labor politician stayed in the bounds the Templars set, and that meant shooting down the free silver movement.

Free silver would allow silver coined into money indefinitely, as opposed to the gold standard. This would directly challenge the system created by the Templars and the benefits of a deflating economy— silver strikes in the West would allow for massive inflation, allowing easier circulation of money to the lower classes.

Ultimately whether or not William E Russel won the Democratic nomination was irrelevant— the Templar Order had no intention of letting free silver go through— but they still saw their control of the American northeast as an important factor. If the Democratic candidate was from Boston, it would allow them to leverage the concept of free silver completely out of the public consciousness.

Adora sighed to herself. She understood why this needed to be done. The public was uneducated, unwise, didn't know what it wanted. And yet, the ruthless support of a quasi-aristocratic system in a country that existed to defy aristocracy didn't sit right with her— not to mention the fact that free silver could very well improve the lives of the common people.

"I am not a lady," Catra grunted out, mouth still full of food that she was scoffing at the luxury of not ten minutes before.

"Still"

Catra leaned back on a table, overstuffed plate in hand. "So why are we really here?"

Adora looked at Catra in confusion, "I don't know what you are talking about."

Catra just stared at her. "Adora. I've known you my whole lifetime. I know when you're holding something back."

This conversation was making Adora antsy. Weaver had specifically requested she keep Catra in the dark about the Order. Something about her immaturity. Whatever the reason, Adora would follow through, even if she wanted nothing more than to confide in her oldest friend.

Fortunately, or perhaps unfortunately, a reprieve from the growing tension appeared then— an tall, lanky man with an elegant suit and long blonde hair. At least she thought he was a man- he almost looked like a woman dressed as a man.

“Ah, you two must be Adora and Catra. Madame Weaver speaks much of you two.”

Before Adora could question how he knew them, the other girl snarked, “Oh, I’m sure she’s told you all about the street rats she’s raised into *ladies*. Very successfully, I’m sure you’ve noticed.”

The lanky man simply laughed at Catra’s indignant response. “Believe me, I’ve never been one to enjoy those sorts of poofy dresses either.” Adora had no idea what he meant by that.

Laughing, the man stuck out his thin, spindly arm. “But forgive my rudeness. I am D T Winchester, the governor’s right hand.”

Quickly, and as hopefully inconspicuously as possible, Adora grabbed his hand and dragged him over to a secluded area. “Winchester, your life is in danger.”

The campaign manager made a show of his exasperation, sighing loudly. “Yes, I get it, Cobalt got stabbed. The gala is heavily protected, it’s the governor’s party. The Assassins won’t try and kill me in the middle of the ballroom, and I intend to stay out here and mingle.” Adora sufficiently unresponsive, he politely excuses himself. “Now if you’ll mind me, I have a perfectly secure party to enjoy.”

Returning to the table, the blonde tried to focus on the party delicacies but was bluntly interrupted by Catra.

“So what the hell was that?”

Adora muttered something even she couldn’t make out under her breath before grunting a quick “nothing.” She could practically hear her best friend roll her eyes.

Apparently unwilling to continue pushing, Catra proceeded to mock the partygoers from a distance, for anything between trying too hard and not having a sense of fashion. Adora successfully

tuned her out before being suddenly yanked back into the conversation with one uncouth utterance:

“Oh hey, there’s the woman that killed the factory owner asshole.”

Adora’s head shot up, eyes scanning the ballroom until they fell upon the woman she had watched walk into Cobalt’s factory moments before his death. Dressed in a similar (perhaps the same?) elegant purple dress, she walked about the floor gracefully, arm in arm with a black man the blonde didn’t recognize.

By the time Adora was able to reach the murderer, a very agitated Catra in tow, the two had separated, with only Ms Moon in sight.

“You!” Adora shouted, causing nearby partygoers to startle. “Stop right there!”

The Asian woman barely jumped, seemingly used to this kind of attention. “What do you wanted with me so much you’re willing to announce it to the entire gala?”

Adora crossed her arms. “To prevent you from committing a-“

“Oh, we’re all just criminals in your eyes, aren’t we?” The young lady interrupted. “I’ll have you know I was born in this country, not that it cares.”

Adora walked in close, growling lowly, “I know what you’re planning.”

Unimpressed, the Asian woman deadpanned, “I’m glad you do. Pray tell what that plan is?”

From behind her, an increasingly annoyed Catra demanded “Yeah. What’s going on? You’ve been acting weird all night. She could just be some lady.”

Leaning over to the brunette, Adora hissed “she’s going to commit murder!”

Clearly not won over, Catra hissed back, "first of all, that might not be Ms Moon. Secondly, Cobalt deserved it. You were there too. Also, why do you even care?"

Before Adora could respond, an uproar had come from across the ballroom.

"Guards! Someone's been murdered!"

Racing over, Adora found the body of D T Winchester, with a long metal blade sticking out from the back of his skull. The angle suggested that he had been shot at from above, likely from a long distance.

"Okay, how did you know that would happen?" Catra shouted, which Adora ignored. She scanned the building trying to locate either Ms Moon, who had conveniently vanished, or her companion. Suddenly, out of the corner of her eye she spied a pair of shadows moving atop the ballroom's chandeliers, moving in the direction of an open window.

Quickly gesturing to Catra, she rushed towards the exit. "C'mon! We need to follow those two!"

Ignoring Catra's infuriated questioning, Adora raced outside the mansion and around the building, looking for a ladder or— there, a convenient pile of boxes. She climbed up the makeshift staircase, best friend swearing angrily behind her, until she saw two cloaked figures arguing on the rooftops, one speaking in a familiar, hushed voice.

"Bow!" The shorter figure groaned— her voice was clearly that of Ms Moon. "You're supposed to wipe the target's blood! It's tradition!"

"Glimmer, literally no one car-ahh!" The other, voice clearly a young man, jumped at the other girls' intrusion. "Uh… hi?"

Before Adora could respond, Ms Moon (Glimmer?) screamed "Templar scum!", running and diving at the blonde, flicked wrist

revealing a hidden blade she narrowly avoided. “Bow, get out of here! I’ll slow them down!”

As the boy ran off, Adora shouted, “Hey Catra?” Apparently willing to put aside her irate confusion, the girl ran after him, leaving Adora with Cobalt’s killer.

Throwing the short girl off of herself, Adora leapt to her feet, brandishing a knife she had kept on her person since before Weaver took them in.

“So what’s that about how you’re not a criminal?”

Glimmer grunted, pulling herself to her feet before brandishing a knife of her own, hers much more decorated than the rusted one Adora had found on the street.

“Must have slipped my mind.”

Dodging the girl’s slashing, Adora managed to get around her enemy, pulling her into a chokehold, knife hovering above her throat.

“Killer’s like you deserve to be brought to justice?”

Squirming in Adora’s arms, the girl managed to grunt out, “Justice? You know nothing of justice!”

Suddenly, a loud noise erupted, followed by an enormous puff of smoke. Adora coughed from inhaling it, before being knocked to the ground by the girl who then began running off. By the time the smoke had cleared, the woman had crossed the street and was gracefully jumped from building to building, running away at full speed.

Dammit. Adora had not only failed to stop Winchester from being killed, she had failed to stop his killers from getting away. She fell to her knees in exhaustion, hearing the footsteps and labored breathing of her best friend coming closer.

As the brunette approached, Adora began, "Catra, I—"

"What the fuck was that, Adora? You've been weird all night, run after a girl you said was gonna kill someone, someone gets killed, we run after them, there's the person you accused right there. What is happening?"

Eager to calm Catra's wrath, Adora started, "It's complicated. Weaver'll—"

"I don't care what Weaver thinks! You're keeping secrets and thinking I'm okay with it! What aren't you telling me?"

Catra was clearly seething in hurt anger— Adora didn't see any point in continuing to hide the truth.

"Cobalt and D T were part of the same secret society, one dedicated to protecting and guiding humanity. When Cobalt was killed, Weaver brought me in, told me about it, told me not to tell you. I swear that's all I know!"

Clearly not pleased but now more calm, Catra sighed. "Fine. Let's get back home, maybe she'll tell me what's happening."

——

After a long walk in silence that eventually grew friendlier, the girls had arrived at Madame Weaver's estate. Upon their arrival, a maid had informed them that she was in the study with her husband.

"Don't disturb them, please. The man and lady of the house can become… heated in their discussion."

Blatantly disregarding the warning, Catra took off towards the study, Adora trailing behind her. Coming up to the door, the girls heard Weaver arguing with the man they saw so little of.

"My brother grows impatient with your work," the voice of Hordak Kur growled.

“My work cannot be rushed! You know this just as well as he!”

“Your ‘work’ has yet to bear any fruit, yet we still afford you resources when two of our men now lie dead.”

“Assure Prime that once the children are unlocked, the secrets of the precursor’s work in Alhazred’s tomb will be revealed.”

“Bold words for a woman whose teacher went mad trying to understand the ruin.”

“Winfield was a genius! Do not speak of him in such a way!”

“Indeed he was. Now he lies screaming in Butler Hospital about horrors unknown, decidedly less brilliantly.”

After a moment, Hordak stated, gruffly, “You have two weeks. The grandmaster wants results, not vague ramblings about keys and gates. Otherwise the project is over.” His footsteps rang out through the halls as he stormed off into another room.

“Happy marriage,” Catra muttered before suggesting wordlessly to let the Madame cool off before interrogating her. The girls started to move away before hearing Weaver’s sweet voice call out, laced with venom.

“Adora? I know you’re there. Bring the brat, too.”

Adora grabbed Catra’s hand, walking them into the study. “Y-you requested us, Madame?”

“I requested you to prevent the Assassins from further mucking up our plans. But I suppose that was too much to ask, wasn’t it. Now Prime is breathing down my neck, and you of all people are eavesdropping on conversations you’re not supposed to hear! I expect this sort of insolence from your ratty friend, but you…”

Weaver reached over to the desk, pulling the drawer out to reveal a bizarrely smithed sword, a thin curved saber with sharp, geometric design and inscribed with bright golden symbols. Lifting

it up, she pointed it at the children. “I tried to raise you to be ladies. But now I see that was misguided. This will hurt, very much”

Suddenly, the sword somehow unleashed a blast of lightning at the girls, who ran out of the study.

“Come back, children,” the Madame sweetly drawled, sword still pointed towards them. “I would hate to harm you more than I have to. Come with me, and I won’t have to strap you down and tear your memories out myself!”

“Adora, we need to go.” Catra looked scared.

Catra never looked scared.

Adora nodded, before the two bolted off towards the street, silently affirming that promise they made so long ago.

Adora looks out for Catra, Catra looks out for Adora.
Nothing really bad can happen if they have each other.

Chapter End Notes

> In case you’re wondering, that conversation between Glimmer and Bow is an inside joke about how one game the player wipes the blood from the enemy’s neck in the memory corridor, next Ubisoft completely forgets that they are supposed to do that.

Chapter 4

Chapter Notes

> Sorry for the wait, I've been dealing with writer's block. Pretty sure this is the longest chapter yet though so ¯_(ツ)_/¯ maybe that makes up for the month waiting.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

When Aurora stirred in the middle of the night , her wife wasn't in bed. Sitting up, rubbing the sleep from her eyes, she looked around for Astra, finally seeing her standing on their balcony overlooking Eden.

Stumbling up from the soft mattress, she trampled over to her lover, wrapping her arms around the girl she'd loved longer than she could remember.

"Why are you awake?," Aurora whispered, knowing exactly what she would say.

"Why did you do it." It wasn't a question. Like she had resigned herself to despair.

"I had to."

Astra spun around, mismatched eyes shining with a fury that so rarely was directed at Aurora. "No you fucking didn't. Juno guilt tripped you into sacrificing yourself to something that you know damn well can kill you. Look at Aita."

Adora sighed, "I did look at Aita. That's partly why I'm doing this. Juno needs a subject to test the project on so she can save her husband. That and it's the only way to save our peopl-"

"Fuck our people!"

Astra’s rage startled her wife— she didn’t think that her volunteering to use the serum would hurt her so much; she supposed she might not have thought about it at all.

Astra took a breath before speaking in a much softer tone. “You hate Juno and our people just as much as me. You think that we shouldn’t have wasted so much time on fighting the humans, that way we could have stopped the solar flare. I just… don’t get it.”

“I had to. I may hate our people but we have to survive!” Aurora was in tears now, wishing that there had been some other way.

“I know.” Astra muttered. “I just wish you knew it doesn’t have to be you.”

With the conversation slowing to a halt, Aurora gave a silent look to her wife, asking that they go back to bed. When Astra nodded, the blonde picked her up, carrying her bridal style to the bed, where the two of them lay in embrace. “I love you Astra.”

When her wife didn’t respond to the reassurance, defeat clear on her face, Aurora elected to continue the reassurance.

“I love you, Astra, I love you, I love you, I love you-“

——

“I love you too, dummy, but I also love being able to breathe?”

Adora shot up from her slumber, startled from her best friend’s words. How much had she heard? She shifted away from Catra, towards the end of their makeshift bed.

“Sorry. Weird dream.”

Catra placed a soft hand on the blonde’s shoulder. “Hey, no worries. I just heard ‘I love you’ and something that sounded like my name.”

Wearily, Adora looked at the girl. “Do I do that a lot? Talking in my sleep?”

Catra visibly stiffened before saying, perhaps a little too forcefully, “No. Just today.”

While Adora wasn’t exactly reassured by the response, she had other things to worry about. She stood up, stretching, back aching from the frankly terrible mattress she and Catra had found last night after fleeing into the streets from Weaver and her… electric saber? Yeah, she’d need to unpack last night at some point. After the two of them were relatively settled. Thankfully the two of them had found an abandoned house to roost in last night, so they had some vague shelter from the elements.

Jerking to her feet, Catra mumbled something about getting the two of them breakfast. Adora was not sure exactly how she intended to do that, as they had not exactly been able to grab much in the way of money or valuables while fleeing for their lives.

“You have money?”

Catra rolled her eyes. “Nope.” She walked over to the building’s drafty window, glancing around before gesturing the blonde over and pointing out a tall, well off appearing woman in long dress, walking through the street. “But she does.”

Adora sighed. When Madame Weaver had taken the two of them in all those years ago she had hoped they would be able to leave this life behind. Ultimately, however, her hunger overruled her disappointment. “Okay. Don’t get caught.”

“When have I ever?” the brunette joked, before quietly exiting the building and approaching the lady.

The blonde watched as her best friend stalked up to the woman, trailing until she caught sight of a pouch of money. Silently the girl crept up, gently feeling the pouch for a wad of bills before pulling

it out, then shoving the woman lightly to disguise the theft as mere rudeness.

Catra made her way back to the abandoned building quietly, careful not to arouse the suspicion of any passersby around her. When she finally reached their shelter, she watched the road for a few moments to ensure they weren't followed before turning to her friend, smug look on her face. "Told you I don't get caught."

Something in Adora's face must have betrayed her unease, because the brunette suddenly got up very close, hands on her head. "What's wrong? You didn't hurt your head last night, did you?"

Adora sighed quietly. "No I just… I thought we escaped this life. I don't want to live like this anymore."

Catra made an indignant face. "And you think I do?"

Adora made a vague gesture with her hand. "No. I just… this okay for now, I guess. But I really don't want to do this forever."

Catra stared for a moment before shrugging, "So you start looking for a factory job or something. I'll steal until you can sustain us. Easy."

Adora sighed again. She supports that Catra's idea had merit— honestly Adora had been thinking of mostly the same idea— but this whole situation still seemed tragic. Like if she had been better they wouldn't have been put in this situation, Weaver wouldn't have… tried to… kill them.

Suddenly she felt a flick to her forehead, and came crashing back to reality, where her best friend was staring into her soul with concerned eyes. "Hey, Adora? You still in there?"

Jarred out of her brooding, Adora spoke quickly. "Yeah. Sorry. Just… thinking."

“Well, stop.” Catra grabbed her hand, tugging it along towards the doorway. If she noticed the blonde’s slightest blush from the contact, she didn’t mention it. “Now c’mon. Let’s get some breakfas-“

“Hello girls.”

Startled by the voice, Adora and Catra looked to the side of the door, seeing the face of the very same wealthy woman they had just robbed.

Adora was paralyzed by fear, but her friend quickly spoke up. “Did you want something, miss?”

The tall woman smiled softly. “I simply wanted to praise you on your skill at thievery.” Adora felt the brunette go stock still. “Your form is excellent. Almost any other person would never have noticed.”

Suddenly exposed, Catra’s voice came out far more meek than previously. “I assume you want the money back.”

Unexpectedly, the woman waved her hand in dismissal. “No. You need it more than I.” She then made a gesture towards them. “I did, however, wish to know if you would be interested in a hot meal?”

Adora’s head was spinning. Catra robbed a woman and now she wanted to feed them?

The brunette look back at Adora, wordlessly asking whether to accept the offer. After a moment, she turned back.

“We’d love that.”

——

“Please make yourself at home. My daughter is running errands, but she’ll join us soon.”

The girls sat at the tables, still somewhat anxious from the woman, Angella. The entire situation Adora was in confused her to no end. Not only were they being given food by a woman her best friend had just robbed and who had praised her thievery skill, but the building she had taken the two to was not particularly close to the area they had settled in the previous night. By all accounts, there was no reason for her to have been walking through the poor district, and it would have just made theft nigh inevitable. Additionally, in contrast to the elegant dress Angella was wearing, her home was rather modest. Not so much to suggest poverty, but by no means flaunting with wealth.

After a few minutes, Angella had handed the girls bowls of oatmeal with sliced fruit and sugar, and sat down i front of them at the table with her own bowl. "So, ladies. I take it you've been on the streets for a long time?"

Adora and Catra glanced at each other quickly before the blonde quickly stated. "Pretty much. We were taken in by a woman years ago but that didn't work out, as you can see."

Angella raised an eyebrow at them. "Why not?"

Catra quickly, concisely responded, "It wasn't safe for us anymore."

As Angella opened her mouth, presumably to continue prodding, a voice called from by the front door. "Mother! I'm home!"

Adora knew that voice.

The young woman stepped into the room, dressed modestly, but unmistakably Glimmer Moon.

"Apologies for my tardiness. I ran into Bow and got distracted but I got the…" Glimmer trailed off at the sight of the girls sitting with her mother. "…Food for the gathering."

Angella waved her daughter over to the table. "Glimmer, grab some oatmeal and take a seat. I was just speaking with our

guests.”

Glimmer sat down with her food, visibly trying to avoid eye contact with either of the girls. Angella watched them, amused, before saying, “I assume you’ve met?”

Glimmer lifted her gaze to glare at Adora. “Yes, I suppose you could say that.”

Adora shot up from her chair, anger bubbling up in her. “You murdered two innocent people!”

Glimmer just laughed bitterly. “Innocent? A cruel factory owner and a corrupt politician, innocent? No, Cobalt and Winchester deserved to die.”

Before the tension in the room could raise any higher, Angella cleared her throat to direct the women’s attention.

“Glimmer, please curb your enthusiasm. We don’t want to drive them further into the hands of our enemies.” She turned to the two orphans, smiling apologetically. “I suppose I should drop the act. I apologize for misleading you, however I needed you to trust me, and I didn’t know how deep Madame Weaver’s rhetoric had rooted itself.”

Adora squinted her eyes at Angella (Moon?) in indignation. “You lied to us, so you could get us to help you murder people?”

Angella turned to her daughter, “Glimmer, would you give us a moment? I wish to speak with our guests in private.” When the spirited girl had walked out of the room, muttering “Templar scum” under her breath, Angella finally spoke up. “I don’t know what you think of our Brotherhood, or even if you know who we are, but from our conversation earlier I can gather you likely have little love for the Templars, or at least Weaver. I wish to help you, but I need to know why you ran away. I need to know what we are up against.”

Adora rolled her eyes. “We just met you and you revealed your connection to two murders we were there for. Why would I-“

“She tried to kill us with a lightning sword.”

Adora spun around to see her best friend’s deadpan expression, shocked she would open up so easily to this woman. Turning back to Angella, she saw her worried expression.

“What did this sword look like?”

“Glowing, gold, weirdly geometrical, shoots lightning-“ Catra started listing off features of the sword before being cut off.

“Yes, but what did the sword itself look like? For example, was it a European broadsword in design?…” Angella seemed genuinely worried about that particular possibility for some reason.

“Curved. A saber I think?”

A sense of relief flashed across Angella’s face before she quickly composed herself and spoke up. “Thank God. Hopefully De Molay’s sword is still broken. It is still concerning they found another Sword of Eden, however. Do you remember anything else?”

Before Adora could comment on the shockingly calm way Angella was responding to the idea of a sword that shoots electricity, Catra went on. “Adora and I had been eavesdropping on Weaver before she tried to kill us. She was arguing with her husband about us, and some guy named Winfield in Butler Hospital. She was doing research of some kind, he disapproved. I believe they mentioned a tomb?”

Angella looked surprised at the response. “That is an unexpected amount of detail, for one so young. Adora, I know you don’t trust me, but do you have anything to add.”

Adora sat, arms crossed, avoiding the woman’s gaze before eventually stating, “Alhazred. It was the tomb of Alhazred.

Everything else was accurate."

Angella gave a thoughtful look. "That's odd. Alhazred sounds a distinctly Arabic name. Why would they be looking for that here?"

Before Adora could ask what was going on, Catra demanded, much more harshly than the blonde would have, "Why the hell are you taking this so well! I just said that she tried to kill us with a sword that shoots lightning and you are okay with that?"

Angella gave a pitying look. "It would be much too difficult to explain right now. Simply know that the Brotherhood is well aware of such items." Before Adora could follow up Catra's question with her own, Angella spoke again. "Our bureau is having a meeting later tonight. If you would like I would have you join us, and tell the others of your learnings. We can attempt to debrief you on what is happening then. Until then, please feel free to use our home's guest room. It's perhaps not up to standard with what you're used to but it's better than sleeping in the streets."

—

The guest room was fairly drab, as was to be suspected from a room for guests, but Adora found it perfectly acceptable. It was nowhere near the luxuriousness of their room in Weaver's estate, but she had never grown used to that anyhow, so it didn't matter. Right now, all she cared about was cuddling her best friend and resting from the… eventful morning.

Suddenly a loud knock came from the other side of the room's closed door. Before either girl could respond, it was violently shoved open, and Glimmer Moon walked in.

"Hey Sparkles," grunted Catra out from under Adora's arm. Presumably the nickname came from the glistening jewelry the girl was wearing. Or maybe her name.

Glimmer simply scoffed before slumping into the chair in the room. "My mother requested that I apologize for my aggressive greeting."

Adora raised one eyebrow. “Thank you?”

Glimmer groaned before responding. “I was brash and didn’t give you guys a chance when you only knew me from two assassinations. You’re probably not Templar scum. Happy?”

The three sat in silence for a few minutes, Catra having sat up slightly though still leaning on Adora, before the blonde spoke up.

“What do you mean Cobalt and Winchester deserved death?”

Glimmer sighed before answering, “Cobalt was an asshole Kur hired to keep his employees in check. Keep them working, crush unions, that sort of thing. Honestly just a greedy capitalist, not terribly interested in the Templars, assuming he was even a member, but his death should allow the workers some breathing room so they can organize.” She paused before continuing. “Winchester was trying to make Russel the Democratic candidate. There’s no way the Templars’ll let free silver become a thing, but if they control both candidates they’ll crucify the people on a cross of gold.”

Catra laughed. “I take it you don’t like capitalism?”

Glimmer rolled her eyes. “Oh, I love the boot the Templars have on humanity’s neck. But seriously, no, it’s just the new aristocratic system. Better than feudalism but like… that’s not saying much.”

Adora squinted at the woman. “So you’re a Marxist?”

Glimmer rolled her eyes again. “As an Assassin I am supposed to believe that ‘nothing is true’, so no. Plus, Marx’s stuff is too authoritarian. The Templars could totally use that too. I’m more a fan of Bakunin’s.” At the girls’ confused glance, she elaborated, “Collectivist Anarchism. No hierarchy, workers own the fruits of their labor, abolish the state, et cetera.”

“I’m pretty sure assassins can believe whatever they want,” Catra muttered from beside Adora. Glimmer just responded by groaning with her face in her hands.

“As in the Assassin Brotherhood, stupid.” At the girls’ further confusion she went on. “We’re the Templars’ centuries-old nemesis. They want order, we want liberty.”

Before the girls could ask any further questions, Glimmer shot up from her chair and moved towards the door. “I’m done with this. You can hear more from the others tonight, but not from me.”

The door slammed behind her, loud footsteps slowly getting quieter as they moved away from the room, eventually leaving Adora and Catra in a comfortable silence.

As much as Adora wanted to talk to Catra, unpack the fact that they had gone from working with one secret society to another within the span of 24 hours, ask why she had been so willing to open up to Angella, but she was tired.

Soon enough, the two were drifting off to a heavy sleep.

Chapter End Notes

> I’d say to tell me what you think is happening but like. It’s not that complicated if you know the universe and have google

Chapter 5

Chapter Notes

> Thankfully this chapter came out in a more timely fashion than the last :^)

See the end of the chapter for more notes

The enlightenment chamber Aurora had helped design was completed. As much as she deeply questioned the ethics of Juno's human experiments, and her wife begged her to stop it, it was done.

Suddenly the screams of a child echoed through the lab. Juno walked into the lab, followed by two Isu soldiers, dragging a human boy no older than 7 by his arms.

Annoyed by the boy's cries, Juno barked at the soldiers to shut him up. Once he had slowed his tears to a trickle, Juno knelt down and spoke to him.

"My child, you have been chosen for a great purpose. Your father Jared volunteered you for my Great Work. You shall be enlightened, and the sins of your parents shall be cleansed. You will guide your people to the paradise they robbed of themselves."

She then motioned for the soldiers to place him into the chamber. The boy was strapped inside, and a helmet clamped to his skull.

Before the machine was activated, Juno looked empathetically into the boy's eyes. "My child, what is your name?"

"E-Enoch." The boy was clearly deeply scared.

"Enoch," Juno spoke, you shall become the bearer of Isu culture. Our Scribe. You shall be Enlightened, and lead your sinful flock back where they belong."

Juno then turned to Aurora. “Begin the Metatronization Process.”

Aurora pulled the lever to activate the machine, heart filled with shame at what she had created.

Slowly the screams of Enoch began to fade to the background…

——

Adora shot up in her bed— wait, no, the Moon’s guest bed?

The blonde shook her head. These dreams were getting more and more intense, but she still couldn’t make out any meaning to them, despite the recurring characters and plot points.

She shifted to her side before realizing suddenly that Catra, who she had been sleeping with earlier that day, was no longer in the bed. A loud chattering came from the dining room, which Adora assumed must be the meeting Angella had spoken of earlier.

Walking out of her room and towards the noise, she saw a lively conversation going on, her usually withdrawn best friend surprisingly active. Upon seeing her, Catra waved Adora over.

“Hey Adora! Have you seen these people’s weapons?”

Adora scoffed, slowly approaching the group. “Yeah, I believe I was at the sharp end of Glimmer’s knife.”

Catra skipped over to the blonde, showing a leather wristband she was wearing on her wrist. “Look at this.” Then, she flicked her wrist up and a sharp blade shot out from inside. “They call it the hidden blade. Apparently they’ve been using versions of it for centuries.”

A dark-skinned woman with curly hair Adora didn’t recognize spoke up from the group. “Once you’ve learned how to use it I can show you some of the fancier upgrades. Phantom Blades, rotating blades for combat, poison darts, that sort of thing.”

Before Adora could question those statements, Angella spoke up. "Ah, Adora, good evening. We were waiting for you so we could begin in earnest. I believe you've met Bow, as he was with Glimmer at Winchester's assassination, and the other two women are Netossa and Spinnerella. They're our other senior members."

The curly-haired woman spoke again, this time to Adora. "Hello, Adora. I'm Netossa, and this is Spinnerella." The plump, wavy-haired woman next to her shyly waved her hand. "Catra has speaks highly of you."

From next to Glimmer, who was still sulking about the other girls' presence, a boy waved enthusiastically towards her. "Hi Adora! Sorry your first impression of me was a murderer! I'm Bow, and I'm not mean!" Glimmer simply grumbled beneath her breath beside him.

With the girls introduced to the other members, Angella continued. "On to the order of business. Cobalt and Winchester have been eliminated. That should help alleviate Templar control of the city, but the Grandmaster will likely seek retaliation. Once more information becomes available, everyone will be informed," She took a breath before continuing, "On a different note, the children who we took note of being adopted by the Templar esotericist Madame Weaver have escaped, as you can all see. Description of the event from the girls seem to corroborate our suspicions that they are important to the Order's plans in some way."

Before the tall woman could continue any further, Adora spoke up. "What do you mean 'esotericist'? And that we're important?"

Spinnerella spoke up from the edge of the room. "The Templars don't act without reason. We've been aware of Weaver's allegiance for a while now, so when she randomly adopts two homeless children we have to keep an open mind about whether this is for public opinion or something deeper. As for the first question, she researches into the First Civilization and their technology."

Before Adora could inquire further, Angella spoke up. “Weaver is in possession of a working Sword of Eden, and appears to be researching a precursor ruin of some sort. According to an overheard conversation, a man named ‘Winfield’, seemingly connected to Weaver and likely the ruin, is currently in Butler Hospital in Providence.”

Netossa raised an eyebrow, “Sword? Any idea which it is? That could help.”

“According to Catra the sword is a saber of some sort. Most likely a recent discovery, given Europe’s recent expeditions into the Middle East.”

Bow spoke up from Angella’s side. “Do you think they found Genghis Khan’s sword? Altair mentioned him having one, but he wasn’t able to retrieve it before his grandson took Alamut.”

Angella acknowledged the theory. “Possibly. It would certainly give some credence to the reported name of the ruin, ‘the Tomb of Alhazred’, though that still fails to explain why they have given a ruin in North America an Arabic name.”

Netossa spoke again. “So did the conversation give us anything else? Anything about the Templars?”

A moment passed before Catra spoke up. “Weaver was arguing with her husband Hordak. He’s seemingly connected as well. He sounded displeased. Mentioned that his brother wanted results.”

“Great, so the Kur Company is rotten all the way down.” Netossa grumbled. “Not surprising, but definitely a problem. Any idea who the brother is?”

Adora spoke up. “Weaver called him Prime. When she was talking with me earlier that morning , she referred to a Grandmaster Prime too.”

Netossa sighed, “I guess that’s something. There’s no way ‘Prime’ is his name, but a pseudonym is better than nothing.”

Catra spoke up again. “Hordak was exasperated, I think. Not terribly impressed. I think Prime doesn’t think highly of Weaver’s research. Said Winfield was driven mad from researching it.”

Spinnerella gave a surprised look. “That is a lot of information. You two have a very good memory of that conversation.

Glimmer snarked, “Probably made up. I bet they’re Templar spies.”

Ignoring Glimmer’s comment, Adora was surprised by the older woman’s remark. Wasn’t everyone’s memory like that?

Angella gave Glimmer a glowering look. “Glimmer, please be considerate. Even if it is a lie, the possibility should not be ignored.” She then turned to Adora, sympathetic look in her eyes. “In any case, now that you are aware of our conflict with the Templars, it is safe to assume that you are both likely to be targeted by them. Catra has already expressed desire to join our Brotherhood, but feel no obligation to if you are still wary— you will still have our protection. I do think that some training in physical combat would be beneficial, in case the Order sends a more disciplined operative to capture you.”

Adora stared a hole in the ground. That explained Catra’s blade. “I… appreciate the offer but I can’t accept. I… the last person who offered me a great purpose in my life tried to kill me. I think I need to really think about my life.”

Angella nodded understandingly. “As you wish. You may stay in my home as long as you need. If you ever change your mind, our door is open.”

Adora nodded, before excusing herself and returning to the guest bedroom, flopping herself onto the bed from exhaustion.

——

After a half hour of Adora staring up at the ceiling of the room, she heard a knock at the door. After a moment, Catra walked in,

more shyly than the blonde had ever seen her best friend act around her.

Quietly sitting down into the chair in the room, Catra spoke up softly. “Hey, Adora.”

Adora answered simply with a slightly muffled “hey.”

After a second, Catra spoke again. “You’re not mad at me for joining them, are you?”

Adora sat up in the bed, giving a soft smile. “No. You found something to give you purpose. I just… I trusted Weaver. I trusted her and she tried to kill us. I don’t think Angella’s evil… I didn’t think Weaver was. I just… don’t know what to believe.”

Catra stood from her chair and sat beside the blonde, arms wrapping around the girl.

“Maybe just don’t.”

Adora gave Catra a confused look. “What do you mean, just don’t?”

Catra shrugged. “It’s part of the Assassin’s Creed. Nothing is true. Everything is permitted.”

Adora raised an eyebrow. “Wouldn’t that mean that the Creed isn’t true either?”

Catra snickered, “Apparently. I asked the same question when Netossa told me it, and she was just like, exactly.”

Adora was more confused now than she already was. “What does that even mean.”

Giggle slowing to a halt, Catra gave a soft look. “It means people love to say that this or that is true and right or false and wrong. People like the Templars, people who want to control you. Truth is a human construct. The Creed is an embracing of free will. Truth

is what you believe it is, nothing more. If anything were truly forbidden, no one would do it."

Seemingly noticing Adora's further spiraling, Catra placed a gentle hand on her cheek. "Hey, don't worry. I'm just saying… who says you need to believe anything? If you want to try and find your purpose, do that. But do it for you."

This was entirely too much philosophical discussion for one night, Adora thought.

"I'm tired," Adora mumbled. "Cuddle with me?"

"Yeah, okay, princess."

Adora slowly drifted off to sleep, entering the land of dreams.

———

"I love you Astra."
"I love you, Princess."

Chapter End Notes

> I chose to make an AC au. I chose this. I knew damn well how complicated this was gonna get.
>
> If anyone has any thoughts, please comment— even if a theory isn't in the plans, I'm apparently open to making my life harder.

Chapter 6

Chapter Notes

There's a tiny timeskip here. Few months. No worries.

Enjoy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

The brisk fall air chilled Adora to the bone as she walked from her factory job back to the Moon's home.

A few months had passed since she and Catra had fled the home of their former caretaker, and into the arms of the Assassins. As her best friend reveled in the newfound freedom afforded by the brotherhood, Adora sought to find her way in the world. She found a factory that hired women and paid decent wages, and worked herself, with a hope that one day she might not rely on the charity of others. Despite Angella's initial insistence, the blonde always gave a portion of her salary to the Moons as rent—she knew they were relatively well off, but she couldn't bear the idea of simply leeching off the family's income.

One day, she hoped to have saved enough money to buy a modest home for her and Catra to live in. No more living on the streets or relying on others for comfort. They could finally be free.

As she walked past a wagon of hay, she heard a sharp whistling sound. She ignored the whistle, only to hear another, longer, louder whistle.

Weird. Adora would have thought the songbirds would have starting migrating from the weather.

Before she could walk much further, she felt an impact on the back of her head. Swinging around, she noticed a small stone conspicuously lying in the middle of the street. Another whistle,

Adora's newfound attention directing her to the hay bale she had just passed.

She stepped cautiously towards the wagon, hand on her knife, just in case. She had taken Angella's offer of training in basic self-defense, so she wagered that she could handle a criminal if she kept her composure.

As she approached the bale, it grew conspicuously quiet. She recklessly put a hand inside to feel for anything, and yelped from shock as she was subsequently yanked into the bale with a sudden jerk.

Shooting up from the haystack, Adora glanced around, only to see the heterochromatic gaze of her best friend grinning mischievously at her.

"Hey, Adora," Catra purred with a sly smirk.

Adora rolled her eyes and blew a hair loose from her now ruined ponytail out of her face.

"So," Catra spoke again, getting up close in the blonde's face, "how did I do?"

"I'd prefer if next time you gave me a warning before you practiced killing people on me," Adora grunted, arms crossed across her chest.

Catra shut her eyes in faux-exhaustion and let out a melodramatic groan. "But Netossa just has me practice on dummies, and- well, I guess nothing changed."

Adora elbowed the brunette in mock-frustration before giggling to herself. She could never stay mad at Catra.

"So, can I go home now, or are you going to try and kill me again?"

Catra made a pleading face, her eyes full of softness. “Don’t you want to see something really amazing?”

As much as Adora knew that that face was pure manipulative, she couldn’t find it in herself to refuse. “Okay, fine,” she giggled, eager to spend time with her best friend.

“Race you to St Mara’s!” Catra yelled before sprinting off towards the church.

Adora sighed to herself before she began running herself. She missed this. Not that she didn’t see Catra anymore— they literally still slept in the same bed, and frequently ate meals together with the Moons— but rather that her job and Catra’s training had left them… not distant, exactly, but perhaps less close than they had been their whole lives. It wasn’t uncommon for them to see each other at breakfast and then not again until dinner, if that.

Coming up to the church, Adora couldn’t see her friend anywhere nearby— weird given her head start and how the shorter girl had always been a faster runner. She glanced around before leaning back on a pile of boxes lying by the church, only to once again her a whistling sound, this time from on top the church.

Looking upward, she caught sight of her best friend, smirking pridefully at her from atop the church. “You coming?”

Adora turned back towards the boxes, and pulled herself atop them, and then up to the church roof. “So, what is it you wanted me to see?”

Catra pointed up to a perch near the top of the church’s steeple, positioned in front of the church where it was only barely visible to Adora. “It’s up there.” The girl then sprinted off towards the tall structure, and began quickly climbing her way around the steeple, leaping around with an agility that simultaneously amazed and terrified the blonde.

Adora nervously approached the steeple, slowly placing a hand in a gap and resting her feet on spots where the architecture jutted

out.

As she slowly maneuvered herself around the building, she heard Catra laughing. “How does it feel being the world’s slowest person?”

Adora just rolled her eyes. Despite how intimidating the structure had appeared, the movements just… came to her. There was no other way to explain, it just felt like muscle memory.

She made her way to the perch and an amused Catra, and pulled herself up to the cocky girl. Crossing her arms again, she grunted, slightly winded from her climb, “So. What was this thing you wanted to show me?”

Catra simply pointed towards the horizon, directing Adora’s view to the city’s smoke-filled skies. The view was incredible. Adora felt herself lower her body to sit on the perch, legs dangling from the side.

“Amazing, isn’t it?,” a Catra’s soft voice asked from behind her, “Everything feels so small from up here.”

Adora had to admit, the view was beautiful, in spite of everything. She felt like something clicked in her mind— just how small everyone really was, how contrived their problems were.

Her problems were.

And then she was startled from her awe by a thought.

“Hey, Catra?” Adora started, trying to keep her voice from cracking with nervousness. “How do we get down?”

Catra simply chuckled behind her. “That’s the fun part.” She reached for Adora’s hand, pulling the blonde to her feet. “Do you trust me?”

Adora squinted in confusion and more than a little anxiety. “Absolutely. You’re my best friend.”

“Good to know.”

Before Adora knew it, the shorter girl was stepping off the perch, pulling the blonde with her, and causing the two to plummet towards the street.

“Catra!”

Then, just as quickly as the fall began, it ended, the two girls breaking their fall in yet another hay-carrying wagon. (Who was leaving these things around?)

Adora shot up from the hay for the second time this night, spitting bits of straw from her mouth and shaking it from her now thoroughly destroyed hair. “Really, Catra? You are such a nightmare.”

The brunette just shrugged. “Eh, years of practice.”

Catra scrambled out of the wagon, giving a hand to the blonde as she left as well.

“Race you home!”

Adora rolled her eyes as she sprinted after her best friend.

By the Father of Understanding, she loved her wife.

——

The Moons had already prepared dinner by the time the girls arrived. After a quick greeting and removal of coats, the girls had sat down, jokingly bantering with each other, as well as with Glimmer, whose relationship with the two had grown to a playful rivalry.

“You should have seen the look on her face!” Catra snickered a good while into the meal. “I pulled her off and she was like ‘Nooo! Betrayal!’”

Angella for her part lightly scolded the girl, “I would recommend that you inform someone before you force them to perform a leap of faith next time, Catra,” but the ill-hidden grin on her face betrayed her amusement at the story regardless.

All things considered, she did find the leap exhilarating. She would have like some forewarning, but it was thrilling nonetheless.

“Come on, Catra,” Adora scoffed, playing along with the banter. “We’re adults now. I can’t believe you’re still pulling such childish, immature- is that a mouse?!” She pointed in a random direction.

Catra shot up from her seat, almost knocking her chair over and yelling in a frightened shriek, “What? Where!?”

Adora just laughed out loud. Catra had panicked one time when there was a mouse near where they usually slept back before Weaver, and she had never failed to fall for the blonde’s trick since.

———

It felt like hours had passed, but everyone was winding down. Catra was the first to turn in for the night.

“Good night, guys. See you later, Princess.”

After Catra had made her way off to their bedroom, Adora heard a remark from Glimmer.

“Princess?”

She could practically hear the short girl’s smirk.

“She’s always called me that.” Adora shrugged. “She says she doesn’t know why, it just feels right.”

“Yeah, because that’s something friends call each other.”

Adora spun around towards Glimmer, taking in her suggestive smirk. “What are you talking about?” She asked shakily.

Glimmer just snickered to herself. “You two have lived in my home for months. You think I haven’t picked up on how you two look at each other?”

Adora glanced away, suddenly very interested in the Moons’ silverware. “I don’t know what you’re talking about.”

Glimmer put her hand on the blonde’s shoulder. “Hey, don’t worry, I appreciate the fairer sex too. Plus, you two wouldn’t even be the only sapphist Boston marriage in our bureau.”

Before this conversation could go any further, Angella cut in with a concerned tone. “Glimmer, perhaps we should let Adora be.”

Adora stood up from her chair, thoroughly flustered and unwilling to continue speaking on the topic. “I’m going to go to bed.”

——

“Why do you keep working with her?”

“She’s my mother!”

“So? She clearly doesn’t care about you!”

“But… she’s my family!”

“Is she? Is she really? I don’t know if you know.”

“As much as I disagree with Juno… she’s trying to be reunited with my father. We can’t just-“

“Yes! Yes we can! They focused on quelling the Hybrids with Project Olympos, and now the sun is going to kill us all.”

“…”

“Look. If you genuinely want to help her… I won’t stop you. I just… I think you’re doing it so she loves you, not because you love her. And she doesn’t. Not really. You’ve always been a showcase.”

“I just… I can’t…”

“You can’t leave her because deep down, you want her to love you. Just know, you don’t need her approval. I love you Aurora. I love you so much. I just don’t want you to hurt yourself.”

“I love you, Astra.”

——

Adora’s eyes shot open.

Catra was sleeping peacefully next to her in bed.

Adora sat up. Why did these dreams affect her so much? They weren’t even real!

Before she could try and fall back to sleep, she noticed the light creeping from through the door. Dimmer than earlier, but still there.

Maybe she should get up for a while.

Opening the door, she walked out into the house’s living room, where Angella sat with a cup of tea, somber look on her face.

“Angella? What are you doing up?”

The older woman was startled by her voice, before calming and turning to the girl. “Oh, hello Adora. Just… painful memories. Glimmer’s… interrogation of you just brought up memories.”

Adora squinted in concern. “Bad memories?”

Angella smiled sadly. “Bittersweet. I regret none of the things I did with my husband Micah… I just wish he hadn’t gone alone

that night.”

The blonde took a seat in an armchair before continuing to inquire. “Alone?”

The older woman sighed in regret. “Glimmer was very young. Weaver was reportedly vulnerable— he volunteered to go on his own, let me take care of our daughter. He never came back.”

Adora tried to smile comfortingly. “Maybe he’s still alive.”

Angella sighed, sipping her tea before speaking. “Weaver is a Templar. They are extremely wary of Assassins. Even if she captured him instead of killing him, her superior would have ordered his death.”

The woman pulled herself together, or at least tried to. “In any case. Enough about me. Why are you awake?”

The blonde slumped into her chair. “Dreams.”

Angella raised an eyebrow, “Bad dreams?”

Adora shrugged, “Weird dreams.”

The tall woman’s interest was seemingly piqued. “Weird how?”

“Weird like… recurring dreams, but they feel real, like a memory. I’m a god, a Roman god. But the gods are people. And my mother experiments on humans?”

Angella prodded further, brows thickening in thought. “Could you tell me more?”

Adora shrugged again. “Sure. I’m there with Catra- we’re named Aurora and Astra, and we’re married. The world is ending, and my mother is trying to resurrect my father by experimenting on people, her name is Juno, but her husband isn’t Jupiter, it’s-“

“Aita,” Angella cut in. “His name is Aita.”

Adora turned to Angella, eyes wide in shock. “How did you guess that?”

Angella pursed her lips in anxiety, before speaking again, voice shaking.

“You said they felt like memories. Do you think they could be?”

Chapter End Notes

cracks knuckles

Time to earn that Isu Bullshit tag

Chapter 7

Chapter Summary

> I finally give you Catradora people with no knowledge of AC some semblance of an idea what the hell is going on with those dreams

Chapter Notes

> Good god this chapter fought me. Now back to wrestling this fic into existence!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

For the majority of her life, Adora had been plagued by dreams. Dreams of gods, of herself being a god. Of her and Catra being lovers. About trying to save her race from catastrophe.

She had always believed those dreams were nothing more. Just the result of an active imagination. She had never told her best friend of her dreams, out of shame towards her feelings. In her mind, the less she thought of these dreams, their recurrence, the appearance of Roman gods in an illiterate child's imagination, the safer she was.

So when Angella suggested that these dreams were much, much more, it was not exactly a welcome thought.

"What do you mean memories?" Adora demanded, "These dreams have nothing to do with my life!"

Angella pursed her lips at the question. "I agree. From what you've said, I highly suspect they aren't your memories at all."

Adora laughed humorlessly. "Wait, so they're memories, but they're not my memories? What does that even mean?"

Angella grimaced. “Has Catra spoken to you at all about the Precursors?”

Adora just crossed her arms in exasperation.

Angella went on. “Before humanity, there was… another people. They created us, made us in their likeness and image, to serve them. A catastrophe struck, and their entire civilization was annihilated. Over time, they died off, and human memory of them became more and more distorted, until eventually all that was left was names and heavily misinterpreted events.”

“Great, so why is this relevant?” Adora was growing impatient with this conversation.

“The precursors were a highly advanced society. They created their own technology to control us— technology that very much still exists. There is very little, if any recorded history that has not in some way been influenced by it— great leaders, religious figures, political movements… all of them had ancient devices controlling their follower’s minds.”

Angella sighed, staring at the ground. “This tends to be the crux of the Assassin-Templar conflict. The Templars see this technology as proof that humanity wants to be led, and take it upon themselves to lead us to their image of a perfect world. We Assassins believe that the people should be allowed to find their own way. That no one is deserving of the power granted by the Precursors.”

Adora rubbed her eyes in exhaustion. “And why is this relevant to my dreams?”

“Because you are not the first person to have these sorts of dreams.”

Adora’s interest was finally piqued. “So what, other people have had Aurora’s memories in their dreams?”

Angella shook her head. “No, Aurora and Astra are new figures. Juno and Aita, however… Aita’s memories have found their way into the minds of many individuals before. Frequently the dissonance between their lived and dreamt memories drives them mad, making them wander aimlessly in search of his beloved”

Adora was fuming. “You think I’m going mad?”

Angella’s eyes shot up in apology. “No, I meant nothing of the sort. While we do not understand the nature of sages exactly, we have enough records of their existence to note a pattern. However, due to your possible nature as another precursor, it’s entirely likely that you may be far more stable— had you not brought up the dreams I would never have guessed.”

After a moment, Angella quietly mused, “Though it does help in explaining the Templar’s connection to you.”

Adora had been turning to storm off, but that statement drew her attention. “What do you mean?”

Angella shrugged. “Your adoption by the Kurs was always something of a puzzle. Templars are no stranger to brazen acts of philanthropy, to presenting themselves as ideal citizens. This would have been an explanation, had they not adopted the two of you quietly.” She paused a moment before speaking again. “Weaver’s attempt to convert you in particular to the order is quite telling. There was something at play, that much I knew, but if she knew about your nature…”

Suddenly a thought occurred to Adora.

“The night before we ran away,” Adora started, “She said something to us. That she would get our memories. Or I thought she meant us.” She thought for a few seconds, before continuing. “She knew. She saw me as a tool. She adopted me to get into my head, and— that’s why she never liked Catra! She was in the way!”

Angella nodded, before speaking again. “Sages with the memories of Aita frequently go mad from their search for his lover. That is likely why your mind is stable— you already found yours.”

Adora’s heart practically stopped.

“You think Catra is Astra?”

Angella shook her head. “Given Weaver’s favoritism, unlikely. However, I do suspect that you have noticed striking similarities— assuming that your dreams aren’t simply putting Catra in her place. Remember, you are Adora. Aurora has been dead for millennia. Your perception may blend but the two of you are not the same.”

Adora gave the tall woman an inquisitive look. “You are… extremely knowledgeable about this subject. Sages and the like.”

The woman in turn gave a sort of sad half-smile. “I do. Perhaps a story for another night.”

——

When Adora slunk back into the guest bedroom, she expected to be treated to a sleepless night, racked by thoughts of Angella’s revelation.

Aurora was real.

Instead, when she slipped back under the covers, she felt a warm body flop on top of her.

“Hey Adora.”

Adora let out a melancholy sigh. She didn’t know what to do with Astra and Catra. They probably weren’t the same, but… neither were she and Aurora.

Adora felt a flick against her forehead.

“C’mon, idiot. Stop thinking so much. You’ll hurt yourself.”

Adora scoffed to herself, before muttering, “Sorry, just a lot on my mind.”

“No worries. Not every day you find out you’re the reincarnation of a god.”

Adora shot up from her bed, spinning her head to see Catra’s eyes glistening from moonlight. “How do you-“

Arms wrapped around Adora’s body. “I… may have been eavesdropping on your conversation.”

Adora’s blood ran cold.

“I’m sorry I— if you want space or—“

She was cut off with a soft, chaste kiss on the lips. All thoughts in Adora’s head promptly ceased.

After a few moments, Catra pulled back.

“You idiot.” Catra whispered, a soft smile on her face.

“I- you-“ Adora couldn’t even put a sentence together.

The shorter girl just chuckled. “My mentor, Netossa, she and Spinnerella are in a Boston marriage of their own. She… may have called out my feelings for you. And said she was almost certain you felt the same. Said we were just like them as kids.” She smiled sadly. “I didn’t know if I could believe her but when I heard you talking…”

Adora’s mind was spinning but all she could make out was a mantra of Catra Catra Catra Catra-

“It’s okay if it’s too weird- I-“ Catra broke into Adora’s spiraling with her own. “I just- I wanted you to know, I’m here. We can stay friends or-“

Adora forced her lips onto Catra, kissing her with all the force and passion her shock and fear had kept her from last time

—

For the first time in years, Adora slept a restful night.

Chapter End Notes

I honestly don’t know why I’m so committed to making this compliant to AC lore. Like I’m pretty confident almost everyone here is mostly here for the ship (If you are not I’d love to know how I’m doing)

As far as I’m aware, if you swapped out some names Ubisoft could probably make this story a game. They wouldn’t, but hey.

Hell, SPoP could genuinely crossover with AC, just say that someone gave the Animus a silly mod to interpret memories in terms of Catradora

Anyway. Rant over. Hope you enjoyed!

Chapter 8

Chapter Summary

> Someone dies, lore dump, philosophical brooding, plot happens

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Deafening noise came from one of the Kur Company's factories; but unlike the metallic screeching that usually emanated from its walls, the uproar today was definitively human.

A strike had been planned for today, sympathizers being gathered for weeks prior, demanding higher wages, safer working conditions, and an eight-hour work day.

The owner of this factory where Adora had once worked had recently come into possession by a young man, Kyle Harrison, most likely through family connection. By all accounts, he was fully willing to give in to union demands— he had confessed to various people that he felt guilty for running his business as he did, but said that the Company had him on a short leash.

So the strike was set to intimidate Hordak Kur and his associates. Show them their workers could control the flow of capital.

Normally Adora would be with her fellow workers, screaming along with them. But not today.

Today, she was prowling the roof of the factory, searching for a member of the local police force— not the chief, but certainly a high-ranking officer.

She saw him by a corner of the building, peering over the edges at his riot-controlling minions.

Adora stalked up to him silently, taking care to not attract the attention of any others. She slunk up to him, wrapping her arms around his face and neck, and flicking her wrist upwards.

Soon the officer was no more.

Retracting her hidden blade back into into its sheath, the blonde lifted the body and carried it over to a large stack of waste, being careful to place it such as to not rouse excessive suspicion. Then, glancing around to check for onlookers, she found the nearest escape route—a nearby path onto a few buildings, which she could easily free run onto to escape the area before diving into some hiding spot on the street and emerging anonymous.

She jumped out of the conveniently placed haystack, brushing stray strands from her overcoat and pulling her hood down.

———

Months had passed since that fateful night when Adora had discovered the truth about her dreams. Initially she was hesitant to accept the idea that Angella had suggested, but the uncanny similarities of the woman's explanations to her own experience, along with how well it seemingly fit into the questions of her life, she had found it difficult to refute.

Soon she found herself poring through Assassin records, seeking out information on the Precursors the woman had spoken of. Knowledge of them was sparse, to say the least, but recurring stories and motifs throughout mythology and the ancient technologies that seemingly inspired them were much less so—swords akin to the one Weaver had wielded appeared throughout history; Jason's Golden Fleece and Jesus's cloak were purported to be the same Shroud of Eden, capable of healing wounds, curing disease, and possibly resurrecting the dead.

Staffs, staves, crystal skulls, illusion-casting apples… the longer Adora read into the history of the artifacts, and the hands which they had fallen into- kings, conquerors, religious leaders… all

great men who had achieved much not through their own merits but because unfathomable power had been dropped into their laps. Dropped by one single organization bent on absolute dominion over human potential.

The Templars caused the slave trade to proliferate, and they decided to end it. The Templars controlled the French monarchy, and they destroyed it to replace rule of kings with rule of capitalists. Any notable figure throughout the past few centuries… the likelihood they had been controlled or themselves part of the Order was extremely high.

Adora had been taught the spotlessly clean history that Madame Weaver had wanted her to believe. Been taught to believe in the narratives the Templars deemed "correct".

Adora didn't want to join the Assassin Brotherhood. Unlike Catra, she didn't crave the freedom granted by the mantra "Nothing is True, Everything is Permitted." She wanted to live a peaceful, mundane life of a middle class worker, free from transcendent purpose.

She became an Assassin because she had to.

———

Adora came upon a crowded street, the one where her mentor Spinnerella was supposed to be awaiting her report.

Great, another test.

Adora concentrated her vision and soon the world became a dark, muffled blur, accented by silhouettes of various colors. Dull grey for civilians, red for guards, blue for possible allies— and Adora could just make out the golden shine of her objective, Master Assassin Spinnerella.

Eagle Vision was a fundamental tool of the Assassins, a sixth sense ability that had to be honed with practice and dedication. At least, that's what Adora's mentor said it was like for her. In the

blonde's case, the ability came naturally— Angella had suggested that her being a Sage, along with improving her physical capabilities, had improved her access to Eagle Vision— something about it being a vestigial remnant of the Precursors' vastly superior mental faculties.

Navigating her way through the crowd, Adora noticed the plump Master step into a side alley, silently beckoning the blonde to follow. Adora continued through the glut of people, lightly pushing people to move around them without rousing any unwanted attention.

Entering the quiet alleyway, Adora greeted her mentor, "Hi Spinnerella!"

"Adora," the woman greeted, "I was watching from the crowd. Your execution was flawless."

Adora blushed at the compliment. "Thanks. Is it bad that I do feel bad for him though?"

Spinnerella just smiled sympathetically. "Not at all. It's a sign that you're human. It means you're not caught in the zealotry that the Templars, even some Assassins can fall into."

The blonde squinted. "Zealotry?"

The master assassin grimaced. "I assume you've seen the way the Templars act— like their beliefs about a perfect world are all that matters, any consequences just acceptable sacrifices. Sadly we ourselves aren't unsusceptible— an English boy named Jack decided that we needed to be feared by the people, and now everyone's heard of Jack the Ripper."

That thought did not comfort Adora in the slightest.

"It's all about perspective," Spinnerella continued. "Some people see the creed as absolute, a right to act as one pleases. But when the Creed says nothing is true… that includes the Creed. When we say everything is permitted, that doesn't just mean that you can

do what you want— it also means that the consequences of your actions are yours alone. All this to say nothing of the great ironies of the Assassins."

Adora's brain almost hurt from thinking about this. "It just… makes me wonder if what we're doing is right."

Spinnerella made a thoughtful look. "Well, 'right' and 'wrong' are already highly subjective. Morality itself tends to be less of a universal principle than a vehicle for religious control. But if we look past that… the Templars and Assassins, neither of us like to admit it, but we see the world very similarly sometimes. We expressly believe 'nothing is true', but the Templars believe it too, in their own way. They don't necessarily believe the narratives they create, they simply believe that humans need to believe something, so they engineer it themselves." A moment passed before she added, "Or they just want power. Sometimes a corrupt politician is just a corrupt politician."

Seemingly sensing Adora's growing tension, Spinnerella put a hand on Adora's shoulder. "Hey, like I said, your doubts are natural. Good even. Doubt is central to our Brotherhood, and that includes doubt of the Brotherhood itself. Let's head back to the bureau. I know you want some time with that lover of yours."

Adora smiled to herself. Ast-

Catra.

———

The months since Adora and Catra had kissed had been some of the best in either of their lives— at least, that's what the blonde hoped, as it was definitely true on her part.

Externally nothing changed— the two girls lived together in an apartment they had saved up for, so in the public's eyes they were in a Boston Marriage, but then, that could have been said at any point in their lives. Behind closed doors, however, they knew what the other was thinking when they looked at each other softly.

Being a sapphist Assassin was something of a double-edged sword, Adora thought. The Brotherhood was openly accepting of the idea— hell, they weren't even the only homosexual pair in their bureau. And the Brotherhood's secrecy allowed them to be themselves more often than not. Yet, Adora couldn't help but long for a day when she could be with her lover openly, for all to see.

The girls were awoken from their peaceful slumber by a knocking at their apartment door. As Adora shook off her dreams, Catra rushed to greet the visitor.

Adora still couldn't fully understand Astra in her dreams. The girl seemed so much like Catra, yet Catra hadn't claimed to have experienced those dreams. Angella's suggestion that perhaps Catra had been substituted in her mind lingered, but there were still questions— why would Astra be the only character to be affected this way? From what she'd heard of Aita's sages, they tended to tear themselves apart looking for Juno— why had a sage of Aurora become so comfortable with a person who simply seemed like Astra?

Brushing the thoughts off, Adora stood up from her and Catra's bed and went to join her lover.
There she saw a well-dressed, highly familiar-looking blonde man speaking anxiously with the brunette.

"Mr Harrison." Adora greeted cordially.

"Please, call me Kyle," the boy shakily responded. "I know that one of you killed the officer the other day."

Adora reached for her knife as Catra spoke, "Are you here to confront us? I highly suggest you leave."

Kyle raised his arms in surrender. "No! No, that's not it! He deserved to die! I just…"

Catra lifted her arm a foot out from Kyle, flicking her wrist so that the hidden blade would emerge and touch his throat without leaving a wound. "Well? What do you want?"

Kyle closed his eyes and yelped, “I’m the next in line to the Kur Company, I hoped you could deal with Hordak!”

Catra retracted her blade and slowly lowered her arm, Adora in turn putting her knife away. “And why should we help you?”

Anxiously, Kyle said, “The union! I support the labor rights movement, I want to help! Hordak is breathing down my neck, but if you took him out of the picture…”

Adora crossed her arms in suspicion. “And why exactly should we believe you?”

Kyle lifted produced a letter from his pocket. “Here. Mr Kur invited me to dinner at a high-end restaurant. Said he wanted to discuss business, what with the labor strikes going on.”

Adora took the offered letter and inspected it.
The words were cordial enough, and she had lived in the Kur Manor long enough to recognize Hordak’s signature and the stamped seal, a pair of bat wings on either side of a diamond, making the shape of a letter H.

Adora lowered the letter to stare suspiciously at Kyle Harrison. “Why would you come to us, exactly?”

Kyle scratched his hair in nervousness. “I’ve heard of your brotherhood, and thought we might have aligning interests.”

Adora glanced towards her lover, who gave an inquisitive look back. Eventually, she looked back to Mr. Harrison.

“You have a deal.”

Chapter End Notes

> I’m finally moving in the direction I want to. Maybe I can start expanding on those names I dropped all over the place the previous chapters

Chapter 9

Chapter Notes

Hope you enjoy!

Also hope it everything starts making sense a little tiny bit!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

The Velvet Glove was a beautiful restaurant, one exactly the sort that Adora when she was a street urchin would only dream of, and that after Weaver's adoption she had grown a distaste for. The posh European cuisine and opulent design… today it made her skin crawl. From her vantage in the rafters of the building, it was thankfully far more bearable.

She and her… lover Catra were waiting by the ceiling for Kur and Harrison to enter the building— their reservation was very soon, the one that Kyle had tipped them off to. As much as she wanted to believe him,(and helped along by Catra's much less generous benefit of doubt) Adora didn't trust Mr Harrison. Everything about their meeting felt… off. Like he knew they would want to kill Hordak… and why.

The blonde felt a soft hand on her shoulder. She turned to see Catra gazing concernedly into her blue eyes.

"Hey, are you alright?"

Adora shook it off. "I'm fine. Just… nervous."

Catra leaned over, nuzzling into her, at least as much as their awkward position would allow for. "Probably a good thing. Hordak is a big target. Just stay safe, okay?"

Adora nodded, blushing lightly. It still amazed her how the girl she had taboo feelings for had them back. Even if she wasn't Astra, something about them felt predestined.

Soon, Kur and Harrison were guided into the dining room, taking seats at a large center table. The girls quietly maneuvered around the rafters, slowly adjusting to allow for better ability to eavesdrop on the two men.

As Adora got into position, she began to be able to make out part of a conversation.

"She's obsessed. Ever since she lost the girl by her own brashness she's gone further into her maddening texts, constantly traveling to Providence to try and scrape out whatever scrap of information her mentor's fractured mind has left."

"Mentor?" Adora could barely make out Kyle speak, timidness clear in his voice.

"Winfield Scott Lovecraft. Former high-ranking member of our branch in Providence. He was an expert on the First Civilization, was called to Chicago to examine technology our European brothers found in the lost tomb of Hulegu Khan."

Hordak's open sharing of information made it clear in Adora's mind— Kyle Harrison was himself a member of the Templars. She glnced back at Catra, sharing a look to acknowledge they both knew.

Turning back, she tuned back into the Templar conversation.

"-arrow lodged in it clearly caused it to fail, so whatever it did, it demonstrably doesn't anymore. But a text that the Mongols brought with them, written in Arabic, made him curious. Ramblings of a mad man who apparently couldn't write his own name properly, but somehow led him to a ruin. He thought it would give him knowledge of the Precursors." He lifted his glass, taking a sip of water, before gingerly returning it to the table. "And I suppose he got what he wanted." Adora could practically hear his smug grin.

After the waiters had begun bringing food to their table, the two men's conversation shifted towards business politics, Kyle heavily

suggesting that the Kur Company relent to union demands and Hordak laughing at his pleas. Interesting to know Mr Harrison was in fact pro-labor, despite his allegiance. Adora eventually tuned out the conversation, and then suddenly noticed how quiet the restaurant was. Kur and Harrison seemed to be the only guests there. That might explain why Hordak was so open about their order, but…

Suddenly Mr Harrison fell into a coughing fit. Almost a minute later, Hordak spoke up.

"Tell me, Kyle, how is your breathing?"

When Harrison couldn't respond, he spoke again.
"I am well aware of my brother's distaste for my practices. Well aware that he intended to remove me and supplant you. Someone more controllable." The tall man scoffed. "The 'grandmaster' has never done anything in his life. He is content on his little throne, casting shadows onto the cave wall for the unclean masses to see. I built my company to forge us forward. I will not let him sterilize my efforts."

Eventually, Kyle's body had stilled, and Hordak waved an employee over. "Dispose of his body." He then walked towards the back of the room, where a door out of the building sat.

By the time the door had closed behind Kur, Adora and Catra dove down from the rafters, landing roughly onto two of the waiters clearly in Templar pay. The blonde flexed her wrist, ending his suffering, her lover doing much the same. The two of them hurried towards the alley Kur had exited from, seeing him climbing into a carriage.

Before the vehicle could take off, Adora ran up to the carriage, grabbed Hordak by the collar, and thrusted her hidden blade deep into his throat.

—

Everything faded to black

—

When Adora opened her eyes, she saw… nothing. Just an empty void.

She heard a slow clapping behind her. Turning, she saw Hordak Kur grinning smugly.

“Congratulations, Assassin. I must admit, I had thought I outwitted my brother.”

Adora rushed towards the tall man but before she could reach him-

“Always violence with your people, isn’t it?”

Adora turned around, seeing Kur behind her once again.

“What is this?” the blonde hissed at the Templar.

Instead of giving a response, Hordak merely scoffed to himself. “Tell me, what exactly did you achieve here?”

Growling, Adora managed to grab Hordak by his collar. “I rid the world of a tyrant.”

Hordak simply shrugged. “Perhaps.”

A voice spoke behind her. “But I will be replaced.” Adora saw as Hordak vanished from her grip, and turned around to see the man towering above her. “Our order is a hydra, cut off a head and two more will take their place. And your people have been cutting off heads for centuries.”

Adora closed her eyes, and sighed.

“Rest in peace, Hordak Kur.”

She thrust her blade, and soon the specter was gone.

—

Adora’s eyes shot open.

She looked down to see Hordak’s still warm body beneath her.

“That was amazing!” The blonde turned to see her lover beaming with pride. The brunette rushed up to give Adora a kiss on the cheek.

“How long was I out?” Adora muttered.

“Huh?” Clearly whatever Adora had seen had taken place quickly enough for Catra to not notice.

Adora brushed off the girl’s confusion “Nevermind.”

She turned back to the fresh body, noticing a piece of paper sticking out from the pocket of the man’s coat. Picking it up and unfolding it, she read its impeccable handwriting.

“Dearest Brother,

My letter is of twofold nature.

Firstly, your tyrannizing of your workers have begun to cause major problems. Radicals will be radicals, but common men have begun to join in their protests. If this is not controlled, the Order’s plans will be thoroughly disrupted. Raise wages, cut hours, improve conditions. This should calm the majority of workers.

Additionally, I have learned about your scheming against Weaver and Lovecraft.
Cease immediately or I will take drastic action.

We are blood but I am your grandmaster. Never forget your place.

May the Father of Understanding guide you,
Annilis Kur”

Chapter End Notes

I’ll let the chapter speak for itself.

Chapter 10

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Hordak's death had sent shockwaves across the Kur Company, and the city of Bright Moon was facing the brunt of the chaos.

Currently the public idea was that trade unionists had tried to get Kur to let Harrison take over, and killed him when he fought back. Adora supposed this was close enough to the truth, but very much skewed to paint the protestors as violent instigators. Word was that the new owner of the company had considered going to talks with the union, but was taking a firmer stance after the ordeal.

All in all, what had seemed an easy way for her and Catra to make things better had in fact made things much worse.

"Why didn't you speak to us about this plan?" Angella was shouting at the girls, irate at the chaos Kur's assassination had caused.

Adora could feel herself shrinking under the woman's gaze. "Kyle Harrison came up and gave us the opportunity— I didn't think-"

"Clearly not," Netossa grumbled before sighing. "This is just like Haymarket."

Spinnerella gave the girls a sympathetic smile. "It's… not good, but this has happened before. Just a few years ago in Chicago, Netossa and I couldn't stop the Templars from arming a group of anarchists and telling them to bomb Haymarket. The fiasco caused the entire labor movement to become demonized. Of course, we did meet Ms Goldman through it, a good friend of ours."

Angella waved a hand at the conversation to silence the group. "Regardless of that, what you two did was reckless. The only

possible saving grace might be Kur's general disliked nature, so this might not be quite as bad as Netossa suggested. However, in the future I would ask that you come to me if you have plans like this."

Catra shot up from her seat, face deep red from frustration. "Well what do you want? Kur was a Templar, a major one! His death is exactly what we wanted, right?"

Angella squinted at Catra in exasperation. "Kyle Harrison was one as well. If the conversation you two relayed is anything to go off, someone else may have wanted them dead."

Having been quiet for a while, Adora pulled the paper she found on Kur out of her pocket. "Catra, I think she might be right." She handed the paper to Angella, who quickly scanned the impeccably neat letter.

Angella sighed. "Perhaps something can be gained from this incident." She passed the note to Netossa, who read it over before muttering, "Annilis Kur? I guess we can give our 'Grandmaster Prime' a name now. Weird to see him supporting labor rights." She handed it back to Adora, face showing her begrudging acceptance of the incident.

Adora spoke up, "Kur also spoke of Weaver's mentor. Winfield Scott Lovecraft. Apparently got involved with some First Civilization technology and paid a price. She's been trying to rip information out of him in Providence."

The head of the bureau sighed, rubbing her eyes, before calmly stating, "Fine. You two may go to Butler Hospital, learn about what they want. But you are to take Glimmer and Bow with you. I do not want another event like this."

Adora nodded in acknowledgment before turning around, seeing her lover storm off.

———

Entering the bedroom of their tiny apartment, Adora found Catra curled up in their bed, thrashing about in irritation. By the time Adora had sat on the bed herself, Catra rolled over, scowling.

“What do they even want from us?” Catra growled. “They want to free humanity but heaven forbid we cause problems!”

Adora shrugged. “Yes, but the Templars are ten steps ahead. They manipulated us.”

Catra crossed her arms in frustration. “So we expose them. Go to the newspapers, bring evidence of their conspiracies-“

“And then they kill us or the writer, discredit the papers, rendering everything futile.”

Catra sighed. “It just makes you wonder, you know? What are we actually achieving? If the Templars are willing get us to kill their own to achieve their goals, if their control is so all-pervasive that killing people in the shadows is the only way to loosen their grips…”

Adora grimaced before confessing. “When I… killed Hordak… I saw something. He spoke to me. Said the same thing. That their order is a hydra we just keep cutting the heads off of.”

Catra looked away. “Yeah, Netossa has told me about those… visions. Strong assassins have them all the time, something to do with Eagle Vision. The Templars almost always talk about how they’re right, how we can’t do anything.”

Adora sighed. “Maybe it’s just what you told me back when you joined. Everyone tells you this or that, but nothing is true unless you think so. Maybe we just need to stick to what is important. You can’t fight every battle.” She then leaned over to her lover, kissing her on the forehead.

“Hey Adora?” The brunette’s voice sounded nervous.

“Yes?”

“You love me, right?”

Adora smiled softly. “Of course.”

Catra looked away before whispering, “Are you sure?”

Adora squinted in confusion. “What?”

Catra grimaced before saying, “It’s just… you’re a sage. You have these dreams about an ancient world, and you see your lover there. And she looks like me. So do you love me? Catra? Or do I look like Astra?”

Adora lifted her palm to the girl’s cheek, bringing their foreheads together. I love you. I think Astra and Aurora may have helped me realize I could, but I think I always have.”

Catra smiled softly at the blonde before pulling her into a tight hug, burying her head in the crook of her neck, whispering out a mantra of “I love you I love you I love you…” Adora happily returned the mantra with her own.

Soon enough the pair drifted off to sleep.

———

“Aurora?”

“Yes, love?”

“I found something.”

“What?”

“The serum Juno got. She’s not supposed to have it.”

“Like that ever stopped her.”

“As in she helped Asgard steal a sample, they gave her some as thanks.”

“That’s treason!”

“Yes. And I have the proof. We can bring it to Jupiter and Minerva. We can stop this.”

Chapter End Notes

> Can you really call yourself an Assassin if you don’t brood nihilistically about the futility of your actions and the Brotherhood in general?
>
> Also, I’ve had the idea that Spinnetossa are friends with Emma Goldman for a while now, so finally I get to mention that.

Chapter 11

Chapter Summary

I write stuff actually happening yayyyyy

Chapter Notes

Good god this one fought me

See the end of the chapter for more notes

“You cannot be serious!” Juno was livid at the accusations offered up by her fellow Triad member. Astra’s anonymous tip had attracted the Sacred Voice, Minerva, to her fellow Isu’s treachery, and Aurora felt a sense of relief wash over her.

“I assure you, I am resolute in my decision.” Minerva’s voice was cold and emotionless, an accurate representation of her deeply scientific, logical personality and worldview. “You will be brought before the High Council, and your fate will be decided.”

“Oh, please.” Juno rolled her eyes at Minerva’s cold tone. “I am the Mother of Wisdom. The Isu Authority may take issue with my methods, but they can hardly disagree that my machine will be greatly effective at saving our civilization from annihilation.”

Minerva crossed her arms. “You know my opinion on your and your husband’s… experiments. The humans may have been made as our subservient, but they have achieved-“

“They killed my father!” Juno roared. “You made that same argument to my father, Saturn, just before they assassinated him before our eyes, and still you argue that they are anything more than animals!” I

Minerva’s gaze softened for a moment. “And I am forever sorry for that happening to you. It was a tragedy, but Saturn was seeing my side. It would not be long before Feyan joined the Sister

Realms in abolishing human experimentation. And even if not— your father was a just man. Do you think he would approve of this torture device you created, to strip a living being of its entirety, reduce it to simply a shell to inhabit?"

Juno raised her arms in ecstatic indignation. "Look at the results! My Metatron Device has already shown great results! The boy, Enoch, has become a perfect Isu, transcending his bastard blood! He has been freed of his genetic shackles, standing a proud example of the Isu's future!"

Minerva crossed her arms, snarling, "And how many did you need to sacrifice in order to perfect it?"

Juno scoffed, "These broken creatures are of no importance. They are mere cattle, as our forefathers intended."

Minerva stepped closer, growling, "How. Many."

Juno scoffed, quickly muttering. "A few casualties, all early on. Later, a few survived but their minds were completely broken. Additionally, hybrids were found to be vastly preferable to humans — our blood has been extremely disseminated amongst them, but those with higher proportions of Isu DNA are significantly more likely to survive with their sanity intact."

Minerva steeled herself, taking a deep breath before declaring, "Juno, you are under arrest for conspiracy against the nation of Eden and excessive cruelty in human experimentation." Two Isu soldiers emerged from behind her, grabbing Juno by either arm and dragging her off, the Mother's shouts echoing through the halls.

Aurora turned to her wife, who had been sitting in the shadows behind her. "It's over. We won." She pulled the shorter girl in for a deep kiss. Once they eventually pulled back, though, she could see something in Astra's face. Fear? Discomfort?

"Yeah." Astra whispered, her face wavering into a slight grimace for a moment. "Yeah, we did."

———

Adora was walking through the spotlessly sterile halls of Butler Hospital, her lover grumbling beside her about being forced to wear a dress— Bow and Glimmer had been adamant that dressing appropriately was necessary, and that meant dresses for the ladies. Ahead of them, the more mature Assassins were following a tall blonde woman enthusiastically introducing the group to the institution.

"Here at Butler Hospital, we follow recent advances in psychology and sociology for our treatments," the woman happily said, "We've officially moved past the barbaric practices of restraints that treat admitted like prisoners, and have focused on treating them as a patient of any other hospital, helping them to overcome their illness." She frowned slightly before adding, more quietly, "Not that that should be a new practice, but alas."

Beside her, Glimmer spoke up. "A question, Miss…?"

"Perfuma"

"Miss Perfuma, do you happen to know of a patient, Winfield Scott Lovecraft?"

Perfuma nodded. "Ah, yes. A very sad case, Mr Lovecraft. He suffered an unexpected fit of psychosis a few years ago, left a wife and child behind coming here."

To her other side, Bow spoke up. "We were hoping to speak with Mr. Lovecraft."

Perfuma grimaced slightly. "Unfortunately that would not be possible. Despite our usual practices, my superiors have made it clear that he is not to have visitors. I might understand that, what with his declining health, if not for the guards stationed by his room and the frequent visits by Mrs Kur."

Adora spoke up at the mention of the name. "Kur?"

Perfuma nodded. “Yes, Weaver Kur. A perfectly fine individual, if somewhat uptight. Her husband was a major donor to the Hospital. Poor woman, what with Mr. Kur being murdered so recently.”

Noticing Adora tense up at the mention of Hordak’s murder, Glimmer interjected, “We have reason to suspect that something concerning is going on with Lovecraft, which it seems you agree with already. Would you happen to know how to get in?”

Quickly turning her head to scan for onlookers, Perfuma quietly muttered. “I’ve heard the nurses say some sort of phrase before being let in. Passcode of some sort. No idea what it means. But if you can find it, that would probably let you in.”

After Perfuma walked off back towards the front desk where she worked, Glimmer shouted in a hushed voice, “We need to find that code!”

Adora instinctively felt her dress for the note she had found on Hordak. She pulled it out, scanning the impeccable handwriting.

May the Father of Understanding guide you.

“Maybe we won’t need to search for the phrase after all.” She said to the group.

———

The wing Lovecraft was kept in was under heavy guard, protected by an iron door with a slot its guard could spy through. Adora and her fellow assassins had managed to sneak about the hospital and steal a few uniforms in order to convince the guard; now they just had to approach the door.

At the iron door, Adora loudly knocked, grabbing the attention of the woman guarding the other side.

“Hello!” The woman said before stopping and saying, “oh, sorry, I mean, uh, Passphrase?”

“May the Father of Understanding guide you.”

The buff woman stared at Adora through the slit for a moment before blurting, “Oh wait, were we supposed to get new people today?” She started fidgeting with the locks on the other side of the door, eventually opening the path.

As the door opened, the woman, Adora now seeing being a tall, buff woman with short hair, gave a nervous laugh. “Sorry, I always forget the memos my bosses give me. Come in!”

As they entered the wing, Adora saw nothing particularly out of ordinary compared to the rest of the building, with just about the same equipment and furniture present. Behind her, the woman kept talking nervously. “Make yourself at home, Well, don’t, but you understand what I mean. Again, sorry for the mix-up. Weaver never tells me when she or anyone else is coming, and the hospital’s staff forgets to sometimes. Just for future notice, though, the passcode is ‘That is not dead which can eternal lie.’”

“That is not dead which can eternal lie?” Adora echoed confusedly.

Nodding, the woman responded, “And with strange aeons even death may die.” Lifting her arm to rub her neck, she continued, “No idea what it means. Same with the whole ‘Father of Understanding’ thing. But they’re both definitely Templar things, so, yeah. I’m Scorpia, by the way.”

After a quick greeting, Scorpia led them to Lovecraft’s room. “Sad case, really. He’s kept so watched that family isn’t allowed to visit. I guess that makes sense in his son’s case, but still. I don’t think his ramblings are anything but craziness, but Mrs Kur disagrees.”

A knock sounded at the door. “Oh, that must be her now!” Scorpia rushed over to the door, opening the slit, and quickly responding with the expected interaction. The door opened, and with a self-important harumph the scarlet-dress clothed woman stepped in. Ignoring Scorpia’s greeting and heading straight for the door, she

gave the Adora and her fellow ‘new nurses’ a passing glance before barking, “Leave us.”

As Scorpia wandered off elsewhere in the hospital wing, the assassins quickly scrambled to the now shut door, eavesdropping on the conversation between teacher and apprentice.

“Still trying to find the key to the gate, I see?” questioned a male voice Adora assumed was that of W.S. Lovecraft.

“The grandmaster has a plan.” Weaver hissed.

“Oh, I’m sure he does. We Templars truly can never leave a piece of knowledge untapped, can we?”

“Annilis simply wishes to use it to further his visions. Lead man to a utopia. He doesn’t understand.”

“Understand what? I feel he is far wiser than you, with your constant struggle to understand the ruins.”

A scoff. “He recognizes that humans need to be given meaning, but fancies himself the philosopher king who can instruct them.”

“As opposed to what, making gods of the Old Ones and making humanity subjugate himself for that purpose?”

“The Old Ones are, the Old Ones were, and the Old Ones shall be. You translated it yourself”

The man scoffed. “There was a day when I might agree with you — I taught you, after all. But here I lay, having quested for the truth and got it, in all its awesome terror.” He chuckled to himself, adding, “Quite ironic, don’t you think, that one would value blissful ignorance only once it has been lost.”

When Weaver didn’t respond, he continued. “In my younger years I studied the writings of the Renaissance Assassin Ezio Auditore da Firenze. The things he saw he simply accepted, wrote that he

would never understand and no longer wished to. I once thought that cowardice, a refusal to seek understanding. Now, though…"

Lovecraft fell into a coughing fit before continuing. "We live on a placid street island of ignorance, in the midst of black seas of the infinity. It was not meant that we should voyage far."

Weaver snarled, "If only your younger self could see you now."

After another hacking fit, Lovecraft responded, "Agreed."

———

Weaver left the room much sooner than Adora expected. When she turned toward the door, she gave an evil smile.

"Hello, Adora. The Grandmaster has been expecting you."

The ebony-haired woman pulled a lever, causing a loud ringing to belt out through the wing, alerting the guards. Within moments the Assassins were swarmed.

It wasn't long before everything went black.

Chapter End Notes

> You think of Lovecraft's monologue as a criticism of Templar philosophy
>
> I think of it as a criticism of Ubisoft's recent obsession with the Isu
>
> We are not the same

Chapter 12

Chapter Notes

Bit of a shorty but dense in information. Enjoy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

“Oh, daughter. Did you think that you could stop me from saving the Isu so easily?”

———

Adora was the last of her group to come to, waking groggily and with a crushing headache to a dark room, arms bound in chains. Her fellow assassins were similarly held bickering amongst themselves in whisper shouts.

“None of this would have happened if you hadn’t just killed Hordak on a whim!” Glimmer spat.

“Uh, Glim?” Bow interjected, “You do the same thing. Constantly.”

Ignoring the boy’s comment, Catra hissed, “Oh pardon us for trying to make the world better! I forgot that the Brotherhood is so high and mighty and values order over freedom— oh wait, that’s the Templars.”

Furious, Glimmer fired back, “I guess you two would know plenty about being Templars! We value freedom, not chaos!”

Again Bow butted in, adding, “Glimmer. Your mother has to tell you to be more patient regularly. I’m constantly reminding you to wait. You would have done the same.”

Glimmer spun around irately. “Whose side are you on?”

Adora cleared her throat, drawing the others attention. “Yelling about mistakes isn’t going to help us. What’s done is done, now

we need to figure out how to get out."

Glimmer shot her an irritated look. "In case you haven't noticed, we're basically stuck right now. I don't suppose you know how to break these chains, do you?"

Adora finally took in herself— her tools and weapons had been taken while she was unconscious. She assumed the same was true with the others. It seemed that they would be staying there until someone let them out.

Fortunately, she didn't need to wait long before a tall guard opened the door with a grunt. He walked in, before unchaining Adora and dragging her to her feet.

"Grandmaster Prime wishes to see you, Assassin."

The guard walked her out of the dungeon into a musky wine cellar, and led her towards a staircase, into a dark hallway leading towards a warmly lit sitting room. In the center of the room sat a tall, well sculpted man with long blonde hair. Upon seeing them enter, he spoke up in an unnervingly friendly tone.

"Ah, you must be the girl Weaver is so fascinated by. Please, sit." He made a gesture towards the chair in front of his desk, and waved his guard as to dismiss him.

As Adora sat down, he spoke up. "Would you like some tea?"

Adora just crossed her arms. "What do you want," she growled.

The grandmaster smiled. "I simply wished to meet with the lady who very nearly joined our ranks, before being pushed away by the woman who sought to induct her."

Adora tried not to be fazed by the Templar's cordial demeanor. "I have no interest in helping you enslave humanity."

He just chuckled at the statement. "Enslave humanity? I'm afraid you misunderstand our goals deeply." He was silent for a moment

before musing, “I suppose your Brotherhood is not entirely incorrect. Many of our Order have risen the ranks with the sole intention of acquiring power and wealth.” He took a sip of his tea before extending his hand in greeting. “Where are my manners. My name is Annilis Kur, Grandmaster of the New England Rite of the Templar Order. Sometimes known as Prime. Pleased to meet your acquaintance.”

Rather than shake his hand, Adora simply asked, “Was Hordak one of those who wanted power?”

Unfazed by Adora’s impoliteness, Annilis responded, “Alas, yes. He was blinded by his own greed. I support capitalism but I am not a capitalist. He reveled in it. Ultimately his strife with unionists began to cause societal instability. It was a difficult choice, but my duty to the human race takes precedence over any individual relationship.”

Before Adora could respond, the grandmaster continued. “I must thank you and your… lover I if I’m not mistaken? Mr. Harrison’s poisoning and my brother’s murder presented a perfect opportunity for us. It allows an excellent display of the evils of both capitalist greed and socialist radicalism. Kyle always was quite naive, but perhaps he can be used an example for how different classes may be able to collaborate.”

At her continued silence, Kur spoke again. “Ah, but I digress. You surely wish to know why your former guardian is so obsessed with you?” He leaned back into his chair, beginning to explain the events. “Well, a few years ago a tomb was discovered in Arabia, with Mongolian scripts suggesting it to be the lost tomb of Hulegu Khan— Genghis’s grandson. He happened to have the sabre which brought the the world to its knees before the Mongol Empire— I believe you’ve seen Weaver wield it. In any case, contained in the tomb was an Arabic text of 8th century origin. Presumably taken from the House of Wisdom when Baghdad was sieged. It immediately drew attention from our occultists, who noticed the symbols scrawled about the pages, and their out-of-place nature in the height of the Abbasid Caliphate. We had the texts

translated— the "Katib al-Azif", or 'book of the unseen', written by one Abdul Alhazred— though given Arabic grammar it is extremely likely that this was a pseudonym. It opened with a preface of his and unfortunate others imprisonment and torture by masked men, his being placed into a horrific device which had killed all before him. He was saved by a Greek woman's arrow to the machine, but the experience had scarred him, and he had gone on a soul-searching wandering which had only left his perceptions of history and humanity further skewed. He spoke of unseen gods unknown to man, the 'great old ones' and 'elder things' in his words, how they created man and we are to serve them. Clearly the ramblings of a madman, but regardless. The paper trail of his work was followed to find what is believed to be the device he was tortured in— and that pointed towards another, in New England. Lovecraft found it, tried to use it, and suffered the consequences."

Since joining the Assassins, Adora had heard of many strange things connected to the Templars and First Civilization. While she had never heard of this particular story, she chose to focus on the important questions.

"Why me?"

Annilis shrugged. "When the New England tomb's machines were activated, and Lovecraft's mind thoroughly fractured, an image appeared, seemingly projected from within the device. An image of a woman, strikingly similar to you, was shown. We have reason to believe you her reincarnation, and the ruin designed to take you. What it will give us we do not know, but whatever it does, you are the key to the gate." The man pursed his lips in thought. "Or possibly the key and gate? Alhazred was incredibly insistent on keys and gates, but what exactly "Yog-Sothoth" means and how it is both is unclear."

Noticing Adora's growing discomfort, Prime put a hand on her shoulder. "I know your people believe our order to be evil, corrupt. In many cases throughout history, and indeed some of my own contemporaries, corruption is abound. But what we stand for— an end to endless war and hatred, and a shepherding of

humanity to a brighter future— surely that is a goal worth striving towards?”

As Adora sat in thought, the Grandmaster called his guards over. “Please escort our guest back to her friends. I believe she has much to consider.”

Chapter End Notes

> The “Greek woman” was absolutely Kassandra. You can’t just drop that the granddaughter of Leonidas has been running around since the Peloponnesian War, dismantling Isu crap, until like 2018, and not expect me to use that.

Chapter 13

Chapter Summary

Ph’nglui mglw’nafh Cthulhu R’lyeh wgah’nagl fhtagn

Chapter Notes

Good god. Hiiiiiiii… It’s been a while.

I intended this chapter to be longer, but honestly I needed to just… get something out.

Anywho I might recommend giving the past couple chapters a glance over to remind yourself. Also if you’re just tuning definitely do that.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

The grandmaster’s words were still rattling about in Adora’s mind. Not the honey-sweet talk about the future of humanity— that was the very same speech of Weaver, all that talk of philanthropic intent, of guiding the world to peace and order. No matter what they meant or wanted, what they were willing to do was beyond any such justification.

(She tried to ignore the part of her mind nagging her about her hypocrisy as an Assassin, killing in the name of liberty.)

No. It was the words of why they had come to choose her.

She had thought for so long her dreams were nothing but the result of an overactive imagination. Now she questioned just how little she was beside them.

She had the memory of a long dead goddess. She had been taken in for her memories.
She seemed to only exist to serve machinations set in place millennia ago.

Her lover clearly noticed her distraught composure from the other side of the dimly lit cell. “Hey, Adora? Are you okay?”

Adora shook her head no roughly, barely able to speak through her existential dread.

“Adora, look at me.” Adora squinted up through tear-stained eyes to just barely make out Catra’s eyes shining faintly in the darkness. If she strained she could just make out her comforting gaze. “We’re going to make it through this. I love you.”

Adora just barely cracked a loving smile.

Suddenly the door to the cell was thrust open, light streaming from the bright hallway. In the threshold stood Madame Weaver, grinning sickeningly sweetly, in a way that for so many years she thought was genuine.

“Ah, Adora,” the tall woman drawled, “Finally you return to me. I trust the grandmaster has treated you well.”

Glimmer hissed from her spot at the edge of the cell, “You won’t get away with this!”

Weaver’s eyes turned towards the short girl, eyebrows raised in interest. “Ah, Miss Moon. Daughter of Micah Moon, are you not?” Glimmer’s eyes shot open at her father’s mention, face draining of color. “I do wonder if sages are born hereditarily. Your father was a great use to us in studying them— perhaps you could serve as a… replacement subject, after his death.”

After the dark-haired woman finished speaking, Glimmer’s pale face turned a boiling red. “What did you do to him!?!”

Weaver simply chuckled. “Simply made him recognize the part of him he had so thoroughly repressed for so long. The madness that came broke his will eventually— the grandmaster suggested he be put down, to end the suffering.”

Before the girl could respond, Weaver spoke again, this time to all four Assassins. “As much as I would prefer to only bring along my Adora, Kur has demanded we take all of you.”

At this statement, Catra began audibly growling, to which Weaver spun around, drawing a shining, electrically crackling sabre from beneath her dress. “Quiet, wench, before I silence you with the blade that brought down your precious Brotherhood centuries ago.” She showily slashed the blade in the air. “Beautiful, isn’t it? This sabre has tasted the blood of China, Baghdad, Persia, Poland, Bulgaria… Some believe it may have belonged to Attila the Hun, and ravaged the Roman Empire.” She turned towards Adora once again. “Having seen so many Empires to their death, I find it only fitting that it led us to the founding of our own.”

From beneath her robes, the raven-haired woman produced a thick, dark-leather bound tome, thick with ruffled papyrus. She opened the text and combed through it, displaying the scrawled black Arabic script, pages littered with strange drawings of symbols and creatures the likes Adora had never seen.

“Some call Alhazred insane. Say his Katib al-Azif is nothing but the words of a madman. But I know. What he speaks of, what he sees… they are true. People whispered of this book for centuries, the legendary Necronomicon, claiming it a dark text of evil. They misunderstand Alhazred. He speaks not insainity or malice. He instructs us.” She closed the tome again, displaying its cover, with a gilded symbol in the center, a sort of malformed pentagram that almost seemed to glow. Weaver rested her hand over the sigil, before digging her claws into it, pulling out the thin gilded crest, its eerie glow now readily apparent. “And he gives us the key to the gate of Yog-Sothoth, so that we may embrace our masters once more.”

Chapter End Notes

> If you’re paying attention, you might notice that my description of the Katib Al-Azif is not how it was shown in AC Mirage. Honestly I just think this looks cooler, but we can

pretend that Basim just remembered it differently, or maybe the sigil was originally separate, added at some point after he brought it the House of Wisdom. ¯_(ツ)_/¯

Chapter 14

Chapter Summary

> Yog-Sothoth knows the gate. Yog-Sothoth is the gate. Yog-Sothoth is key and guardian of the gate. Past, present, future, all are one in Yog-Sothoth. He knows where the Old Ones broke through of old, and where they shall break through again. He knows where They have trod earth's fields, and where They still tread them, and why no one can behold Them as They tread.

Chapter Notes

> For atmosphere:
> https://m.youtube.com/watch?v=ZXI6-u5uyjQ

See the end of the chapter for more notes

The journey took a couple days by ship— Kur had insisted on the usage of a smaller schooner without use of steam power to deter unwanted attention, greatly reducing their efficiency.

The assassins were still tied up, with Weaver guiding the crew while the Grandmaster watched the kids in the hull.

Suddenly, he addressed Adora. "I don't blame you for disagreeing with Weaver."

At her visible confusion, he elaborated. "Her obsession with the precursors… while useful in acquiring artifacts, it is hardly healthy. She feels a need to finish her teacher's work, despite knowing well what it did to him." He looked away, quietly adding, "I fear for our order's ideals in the face of these passions. We desire to be gods, but fail to consider who these gods were. After all, if God created Man in his likeness, what does that say about Him?"

He turned his back nonchalantly, arms folded behind his back. "Rodrigo Borgia maneuvered his way to the papacy, only to learn

his nemesis was the prophet. Reginald Birch's obsession blinded him to the ire growing towards him, especially when the Kenway boy started asking about his father. Crawford Starrick's hare-brained scheme to steal the New World Shroud caused his empire to crumble like a house of cards, leaving the order to struggle to retake London after the chaos unleashed by the Fryes and their Rooks. Even after the havoc unleashed in the colonies by the box of Auditore that Master Cormac stopped, still experimentation with its properties continue. Last I heard, sent to our agents in St Petersburg." He sighed, turning back to the Assassins. "I do deeply fear the possibility of our order being corrupted by the blind lust for power these artifacts evoke."

To Adora's side, Glimmer let out a humorless laugh. "Corrupted? You Templars are nothing but corrupt!"

The grandmaster thoughtfully lifted his head. "It is a sad fact, that power is so prone to corruption. It would be unfair for me to dismiss your thought out of pocket— after all, I had my own brother killed by one of your own for that very fact. But the truth is… no matter how much humanity may clamor for liberty, the truth is that in equal measure it craves stability. Security. You may throw a revolution against a corrupt system, but watch as a new one is created, naively thought to be different. And the very same corruption occurs." He lowered his head to the purple robed girl, face blank save for a slight raised eyebrow. "Tell me, if you could bring about your ideals… what would such a world look like? Do you even know? Is it not your Creed that Nothing is True? What makes you think your world would be better, even different?"

Glimmer simply growled at Kur, who turned his back once more. "The irony is that we Templars and Assassins— we could work together. It's happened before. After all, no matter how we may scorn your methods, it is no secret that they are effective. An Order to shepherd humanity with a Brotherhood to weed out the parasites might be the best scenario. Alas, you clamor endlessly for a naive dream, while we drift further and further to the cancer you see us as."

Suddenly, a knock at the door revealed a sinisterly smiling Madame Weaver.

“We have arrived.”

———

At first when Adora and her friends were brought up from the hull, she saw nothing but empty ocean. An eerily calm, empty ocean, which sent foreboding chills she could not explain.

Then Weaver lifted the starred seal… and then it was.

The structure was towering, with strange geometry not unlike those detailed in the Assassin texts she had read at the Bureau. At the front was a huge wall, carved with strange, alien directionality, all coming from a single round notch in the center.

Walking down from the ship towards the wall, Weaver placed a hand upon it, fingers tracing the strange glyphs.

“Beautiful, isn’t it?” she drawled ghoulishly. “The gate of Yog-Sothoth.”

She lifted the seal once more, and placed it into the notch, whereupon the wall let loose a strange mechanical noise not unlike that of an engine starting. The grooves of the carved wall began to glow the same eerie golden light the seal gave off, and before long the wall began lowering, revealing a stairway downwards, the alien carvings and bizarre glow continuing to the bottom.

Upon reaching the end, the descent opened into a huge expanse, a huge glowing structure sitting in the center, and glass walls all around holding the ocean back.

Behind Adora, Bow muttered, “A Precursor Ruin… they really are as awesome as they’re described.”

“Indeed, child,” Weaver mused, continuing to walk towards the structure in the center.

Beside the blonde, Catra had an unreadable look on her face. At Adora’s glance, the brunette shook her head vigorously, and whispered, “Sorry. Just I can’t help feeling like…” she trailed off, quickly grunting out “It’s nothing.”

As Adora was brought towards the center— the structure she could now make out as some kind of chair, with wiring connecting the floor and ceiling, and glowing that unnatural gold— she saw a disturbing sight.

A glowing, moving portrait, seemingly propped off the open air… one which uncannily resembled the face Adora saw every day in the mirror.

“Behold! Your true self!” Weaver exclaimed. “The face of a Precursor, one which you are the memory of!”

Adora kept staring at the portrait— it seemed to exist in three dimensions, except when she reached out a hand, it was entirely immaterial. The clothing worn by her clone was completely alien— silver and gold trimmed dress, and metallic robes, the likes she had only seen in her dreams. But the face, the hair, the eyes, the smile— it was unmistakably Adora.

“Beautiful, isn’t it?” The tall, scarlet-dress clad woman who raised her hissed sweetly. “This place.. it was built for you. My mentor, Winfield Scott Lovecraft, tried to use it, and it left him scarred. I thought perhaps any sage may work, so I found Mr Moon and tested it on him, to similar effect. And then what should happen but that I find an orphaned girl with that very same face? And so I took you in, tried to craft you into the vessel your were born to be.”

Suddenly arms roughly grabbed from behind Adora, moving her towards the seat. “How unfortunate it had to be this way,” she

heard Weaver's sinister voice from behind, as the Templar's goons muscled her in the direction of the Precursor Machine.

/\/\/\

"You stripped that child of who he was!"

Her mother simply laughed. "For what his 'humanity' was worth, yes, I suppose."

\/\/\/

Weaver towered over Adora's body, numb from the shocks of the machine.

"Now may we witness the rebirth of true civilization!"

/\/\/\

"You are the key to ensuring humanity shall be returned to its rightful place in the world!"

\/\/\/

"The dawn of a new golden age, shepherded by the enlightened!"

/\/\/\

"A new era where Our People are once more supreme!"

\/\/\/

Adora opened her eyes, and saw Catra back behind Weaver. Her eyes showed something unrecognizable. Yet familiar somehow.

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"It's okay, my love. I've got you. I'm not letting go. Stay with me."

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———

Adora was awake. Sort of. She was clearly not in the waking world, and if she really put her mind to it she could feel the electricity of the machine coursing through her, albeit dampened to a dull roar.

All around her was… space. Nothingness. A void of mathematical complexity, ever shifting in its absence yet fullness.

Suddenly the very same uncanny image which had been in the Precursor Temple appeared before her, this time in movement, pacing and holding a strange box of shifting gears.

And then the image looked directly at her, and spoke in a voice simultaneously completely familiar and foreign to the Assassin.

“Hello, Adora.”

Adora jumped at the voice that could have only been her own.

“My name is Aurora. And I am so sorry.”

Chapter End Notes

Honestly was probably a good thing to put that random buffer chapter after my summer-long hiatus :P

Chapter 15

Chapter Summary

> Man rules now where They ruled once; They shall soon rule where man rules now. After summer is winter, after winter summer. They wait patient and potent, for here shall They reign again.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Adora stared at her doppelgänger for a few seconds.

Finally, after a lifetime of confusion with her dreams, she was face-to-face with Aurora.

"I know you have questions, Adora." The spirit said. "I can try to answer, but I need you to know. You are not me."

Adora furrowed her brow. "How did you know my name, then?"

Aurora gestured to the item in her hand, a box-like shape with gears whirring inside. "I read the calculations. I'm not really with you— by my estimate, you were born several tens of millennia after my death. Almost 67,000 years."

"Then how are you answering me?"

Aurora shrugged. "Like I said, calculations. My race, we see… saw, in your case… the world as mathematical equations. Ones which we could solve. I performed the calculations necessary, and found you and our most likely conversation."

Adora squinted at the woman before her. "You said I am not you. What did you mean by that?"

Aurora grimaced, then gave a comforting smile. “You hold a high percentage of my genetics, giving you my memories, as well as unparalleled access to our sixth sense, Gnosis. When my mother Juno’s Relay Machine was first activated, it sent a signal which activated a dormant gene that gave you these gifts. But your personality, your experience, your beliefs… they are yours.”

Aurora looked away for a moment. “For now, at least.”

“For now?” Adora pressed further.

Aurora somberly sighed. “Your race were made to be slaves. Biologically engineered from lesser hominid species, to be intelligent, problem-solving, beasts of burden. Controlled by technology that sends signals to the neurotransmitter in your brains. An Isu scientist fell in love with a human woman, removed her transmitter, and they had a child named Eve, part Isu and part Human. She stole an apple, gave it to the human Adam. One thing led to another, and soon our two races were engrossed in bitter war. So much so that neither saw the threat from the sun until it was too late.”

“My mother,” Aurora spat the name like a curse, “is a firm believer in this… natural order, as she so kindly puts it. Isu supremacy over humans. Says that slaves will always be slaves. Once the master is gone they will simply enslave each other. So she put plans into motion to return the world to a ‘proper’ place.”

Aurora lifted a hand in gesture, and suddenly in the ever-shifting void a machine not unlike that Adora was placed in materialized, with figures appearing, armored soldiers forcing a young boy into the seat.

“The first version of this machine was made to supercharge Isu genes, overpowering a subject’s humanity. The boy, Enoch, a descendant of Eve’s… he lost everything. Was stripped of himself, made into nothing more than a sentinel for my mother’s will. She dared to call him ‘perfect’.”

“I remember that!” Adora shouted angrily. “You helped her!”

Aurora simply nodded. “To my eternal shame. I did not like what she was doing, but I thought she was justified in trying to save our people. But all she wanted was control. Astra showed me that, showed me true love. It wasn’t until my mother turned to me that I realized the horror she wished to commit.”

The area around Adora began to shift unstably, as if the very fabric of reality was falling apart. Noticing this, Aurora began to speak much faster, her appearance’s stability rapidly declining. “Listen Adora! My wife sabotaged the machine! Hid her memories inside, so that she could pass unnoticed, and protect you! Trust her!”

The rest of the shifting void continued collapsing around Adora, the grey abyss slowly encircling around her until
XXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX
———

Adora groggily opened her eyes to a metallic voice screeching around the machine.

“…After summer is winter, after winter summer, after summer is winter…”

The Templar Grandmaster was growing noticeably agitated. “Weaver! Shut that noisemaker off and get the machine back on! You promised results!”

Weaver, for her part, was frantically marching about, searching for a source of the chaos.

Adora glanced to the back where her fellow Assassins were. At least they used to be.

How had they escaped?

Suddenly three Templar guards were knocked out, revealing the three Assassins, fighting bare knuckled yet putting up their own.

Adora heard her lover's unmistakable voice bark out orders. "You two, handle the guards and Kur! I'll get the sword!" She then rolled through several cane sword strikes and ran directly towards Weaver, tackling her.

"What do you want, you mongrel!" Weaver snapped, before noticing the Precursor sword being stripped from her robes. "Give that back!
You'll ruin everything!" She shifted to grab a revolver from her robes before facing an enormous blast of energy from the sabre.

Several guards, now alerted by the usage of the sword's power, drew up their revolvers and began firing at Catra— and yet regardless of where they were aiming, the woman was untouchable. With flashes of light, the brunette would disappear and reappear, and soon Weaver's henchmen were eliminated.

Turning towards Adora, Catra smiled anxiously.
"Hey, Adora." She leapt up onto the machine, Precursor sword at her side, and began scaling towards the top. "There's a weak spot in the machine!" the woman shouted from high up. "When you see the sparks, run! I'll catch up!"

Weaver had come back to her senses, and was now screaming at the guards, her arms flailing up, pointing towards Catra. "Draw up your rifles! Kill the bastard girl!"

Catra kept climbing, her uncanny ability to dodge attacks further being shown as she phased between rifle shots. Eventually she made it to near the top of the machine, and, drawing up the Khan's sabre, drove it deep into the machine, a flash of energy blasting from all around.

Suddenly a booming voice came from around the room: "THREAT DETECTED. EMERGENCY PROTOCOL ENGAGED."

The glass walls holding back the ocean began to lift, allowing sea water to pass through into the Temple. Adora bolted from her seat, where she was quickly joined by her lover, who had leapt

from the quickly collapsing machine, breaking into a roll to mitigate injury from the fall.

Glimmer and Bow rushed towards them. “This place is flooding!” The boy yelled, voice cracking with fear. “We need to get out before we drown!”

Catra scoffed, ominously muttering, “If we’re lucky we’ll drown.” The Assassins started to run back to the staircase to the surface, but before they could make it very far, Adora felt a clawed hand grasping into her shoulder. Glimmer and Bow kept running, not noticing their friends not following them.

“Oh, Adora.” The blonde turned around to see the woman who raised her, holding her and Catra back, body twitching with rage. “We could have been great. Ushered in a golden age of humanity. But no. This mongrel,” she spat towards the brunette, “had to go and ruin your destiny. I could have killed her so many years ago, but thought she was needed to keep you happy. But now I see, she was nothing but a burden.”

Before either girl could retort back, a horrific screeching gurgle emanated from the inside of the ruin. At the sudden distraction, Catra made a swift elbow chop at Weaver’s throat, knocking her to the ground. She then grabbed Adora’s hand and dashed towards the exit. “Listen, love, don’t look back. We need to run, and not look back. There’s something in there… guarding the place… Olympos Project… something too horrific to exist. You look at it, you give it power.”

As the two sprinted, the horrific gurgling sound grew louder. Eventually, Weaver’s voice let out a bloodcurdling scream, before quickly being silenced by whatever was behind them.

———

Eventually the two women caught up with their fellow Assassins, just barely outrunning the ruin’s flooding and escaping the abomination that dwelled inside.

Glimmer rushed over, wrapping the two in a crushing hug. “Oh my god, I thought you were gone.” Bow then beckoned the girls towards the gateway back to the surface, which the Assassins quickly accepted.

Outside, the Templar Grandmaster was standing, holding the book which had led them to this very ruin, an unreadable yet unmistakably dark look on his face. He dropped the book, then drew a match, and lit the cursed book up in flames. He then turned to his enemies.

“Well, I suppose this is the end.” He shrugged, before sighing. “I knew the Precursors’ technology brought nothing but pain. Yet I allowed Weaver’s obsession.” He turned around again. “No matter, I suppose. The order will rise again. It always does.”

Before he could speak further, a rifle shot was heard, and Annilis Kur dropped dead. The Assassins turned towards the sea, noticing a nondescript boat appearing from the mist. Docking on the shore, it revealed the faces of the Master Assassins Netossa and Spinnerella.

“Finally, we found them!” Spinnerella muttered, before shouting, “Kids, Angella has been worried sick!”

Looking back towards the tomb, Adora spotted the seal from the Necronomicon. She walked over, placing her hand over its smooth, eerily glowing surface, and ripped it from the notch. The gateway quickly began to shut once more.

As long as the that seal never fell into the wrong hands, that ruin would never be found agai—

XXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX
Simulation Shutting Down
XXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX
Transmissions Detected
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Master Berg,

The discovery of the Isu Key, and the genetic memories contained were fascinating! Obviously the DNA sequencing of the Sage "Adora" (Due to cyberattacks by the hacker terrorists Erudito, many character's real names are unclear) gave way to the revelation of the "Relay", but also her story is genuinely fascinating— multiple Helix analysts have come to agreement that the story "The Call of Cthulhu" by H.P. Lovecraft may have been based on the events. (Do we have records on Lovecraft's Templar status?) I have already asked our employees to continue investigations— with a minor bit of touch-ups to remove classified info about the Assassins and Templars and emphasize horror, this could easily be made into a great Animus Feature Film; the heavy presence of LGBTQ characters is also a major appeal, and would serve for great PR marketing.

Sincerely,
Melanie Lemay, CCO Abstergo Entertainment

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Abstergo High Command—

Sigma Team has recovered Sword of Eden #2, lodged inside the Precursor machine. It has appeared to have sustained minimal damage; examination underway.

The creature dwelling within the ruin, designated "Cthulhu" by Abstergo scientists, is under study; the creature gives off extreme waves of neurotransmission unseen throughout , having been shown by mentally crippling a member of our team. Creature is currently pacified; however, preliminary scans indicate a well-preserved human female with same appearance as the esotericist in the sage's memories; Sigma Team is currently underway developing a method to safely extract the corpse for sequencing.

Precursor investigators are currently underway attempting to reverse engineer the “Relay” Machine; with the Threat of the Isu Juno and the Instruments of the First Will having been neutralized in August 2018, the machine may be put to better use in Abstergo’s hands.

What happened to the two sages following the Relay event in 1896 is currently unknown.

May the Father of Understanding guide you,

Otso Berg

Chapter End Notes

Initially I wasn’t planning on including the modern-day plot but like obviously I needed to.

Now that the story is officially over, feel free to ask about what the hell just happened.

Fyi, Aurora and Astra are obviously my OCs(ish). Juno is not.

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!